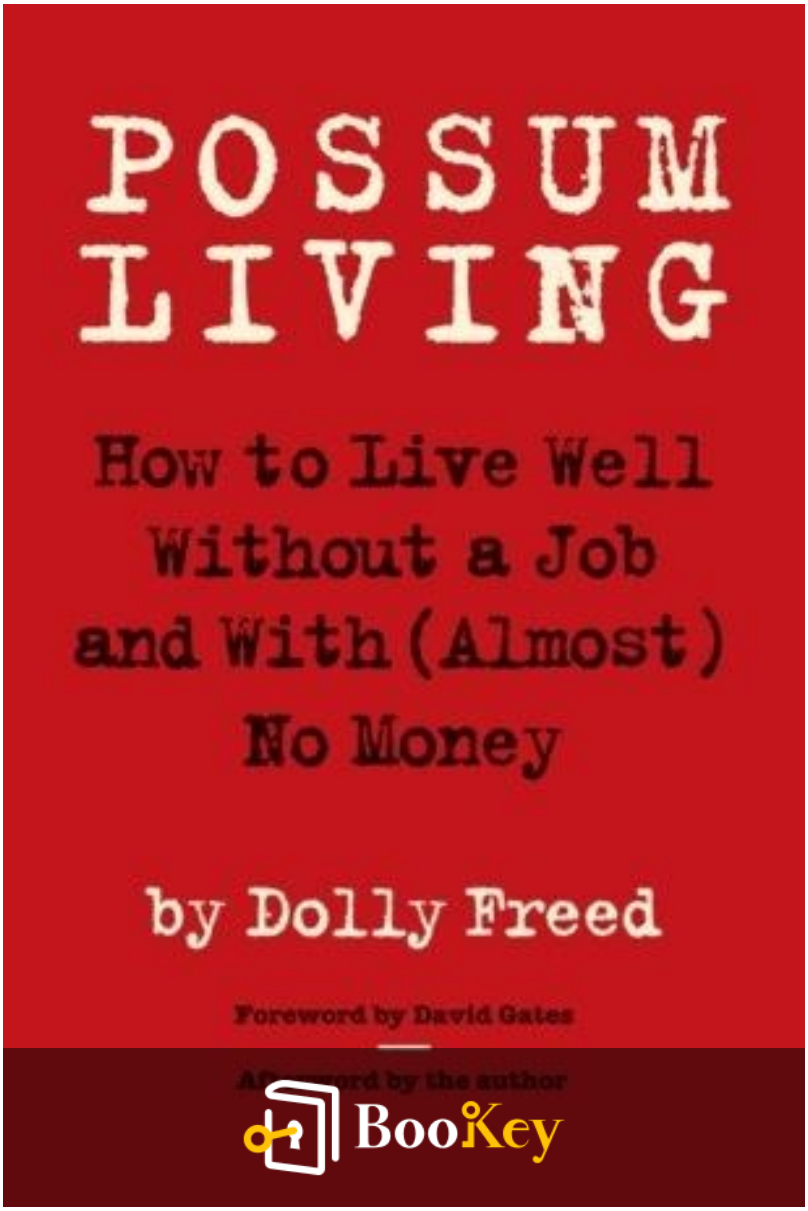
# Possum Living PDF

## Dolly Freed




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# Possum Living

Embrace simplicity: A guide to living frugally and joyfully.

Written by Bookey

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# About the book

In her groundbreaking book, *Possum Living*, Dolly Freed recounts her unconventional five-year experience of living off the land with her father on a modest half-acre lot just outside Philadelphia. First published in 1978, this beloved classic delivers a spirited blend of practical advice and irreverent humor that inspires readers to break free from societal expectations and embrace frugal living. Freed's engaging narrative covers everything from home maintenance and personal style to navigating legal challenges and enjoying a leisurely life while preserving a middle-class image. Now, three decades later, this updated edition offers fresh insights and reflections from a wiser Freed, whose journey toward financial security and confidence resonates as powerfully today as it did upon its release.

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# About the author

Dolly Freed is an American author and permaculture advocate best known for her influential book "Possum Living: How to Live Well Without a Job and With Almost No Money," published in 1978. Growing up in the suburbs of Pennsylvania, Freed cultivated a deep appreciation for self-sufficiency and sustainable living, drawing from her experiences with her unconventional upbringing alongside her father, who embraced a lifestyle centered on subsistence and resourcefulness. Through her engaging narrative and practical insights, Freed successfully inspires readers to rethink their relationship with consumerism and envision an alternative way of living that prioritizes sustainability, creativity, and independence. Her work remains a timely guide for those seeking a simpler, more intentional life amidst modern societal pressures.

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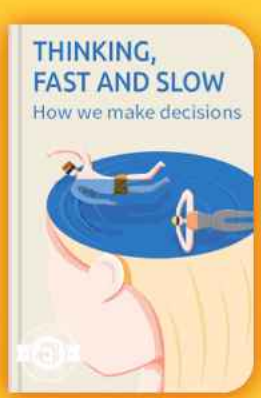
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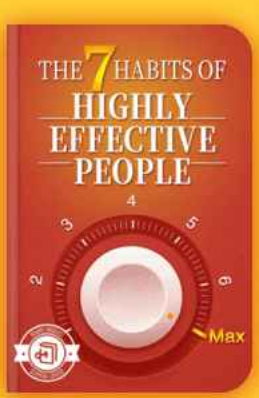
















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# Chapter 1 Summary : An Introduction to Possum Living



| Chapter Section | Summary |
|---|---|
| Introduction to Possum Living | The chapter discusses the feeling of being trapped in the 9-to-5 work cycle and the common fears associated with rejecting traditional employment. The author shares her experience of living simply with her father on a half-acre property, highlighting how they thrive without conventional jobs, yet maintain a middle-class lifestyle. |
| Challenging Economic Norms | The author critiques society's obsession with economic growth and metrics like GNP, suggesting that true fulfillment and self-sufficiency can be achieved without these constructs. She emphasizes that they manage to produce their own food and drink at low costs, illustrating the importance of personal effort over economic indicators. |
| Encouragement for Independent Thinking | This book encourages readers to think independently about economics and its impact on their lives, especially in light of potential shortages. The author advocates for a lifestyle centered on enjoyment and self-reliance rather than adherence to traditional economic measures. |

## Introduction to Possum Living

In today's society, many individuals feel trapped in the 9-to-5 cycle, believing there's no alternative to this lifestyle. Common concerns include pride in rejecting welfare, fear of

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unemployment, and the misconception that one must join a commune or live in isolation to escape the money-driven economy. However, the author shares her personal experience living with her father on a half-acre property near Philadelphia, emphasizing that they thrive without traditional jobs or heavy labor while maintaining a semblance of a middle-class lifestyle.

**Challenging Economic Norms**

The author critiques the societal fixation on economic growth and metrics like GNP, arguing that humanity has lived well without these constructs for centuries. She highlights their self-sufficiency in producing food and drink at a remarkably low annual expense, reinforcing the notion that fulfillment comes from personal effort rather than economic indicators.

**Encouragement for Independent Thinking**

This book aims not only to provide practical money-saving advice but also to encourage readers to think independently about how economics influence their lives, especially in the face of potential future shortages. The author invites readers to embrace a broader perspective on living well, grounded in

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enjoyment and self-reliance rather than conventional economic measures.

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## Critical Thinking

Key Point:The critique of traditional economic norms is vital for personal freedom.

Critical Interpretation:Dolly Freed's perspective in 'Possum Living' challenges entrenched beliefs about economic success and independence by advocating for self-sufficiency and personal fulfillment outside conventional metrics. Though her lifestyle may appeal to some, skeptics might argue that such a radical departure from societal norms isn't practical for everyone. Not all circumstances allow individuals the liberty to entirely opt out of the traditional 9-to-5 model, as evidenced by literature on economic dependence and the structural forces that bind people to certain jobs (e.g., 'Nickel and Dimed' by Barbara Ehrenreich). Thus, while Freed's insights are refreshing, readers should critically evaluate their feasibility in the modern economic landscape.

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**inspiration**

Key Point:Embrace self-sufficiency and independent living.

Life inspiration:Imagine waking up each day with the freedom to create your own routine, unbound by the constraints of a traditional job. The key point from this chapter encourages you to break free from the shackles of societal expectations around work and self-worth. Instead of measuring your value by your paycheck or the metrics of economic growth, consider the satisfaction that comes from cultivating your own food, mastering new skills, and relying on your creativity and resourcefulness. By adopting this mindset, you not only reclaim your time but also foster a deeper connection to your surroundings and a sense of fulfillment that money simply cannot buy.

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# Chapter 2 Summary : 1. We Quit the Rat Race



## We Quit the Rat Race

### Diogenes' Philosophy

Diogenes, an ancient Athenian philosopher, advocated for minimalism, believing that possessions complicate life. He famously discarded his drinking cup upon seeing a child drink by hand, embodying the idea that luxuries disrupt natural simplicity. His lifestyle, although unconventional, garnered him respect and social connections, even attracting notable figures like Alexander the Great.

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## Inspired by Diogenes

The author reflects on her father's admiration for Diogenes, which influenced their own life choices. After illustrating Diogenes' philosophy, her family adopted austerity measures, initially with the goal of achieving financial stability.

## Unexpected Success

The mother began making and selling candles as a means to recover costs, unexpectedly turning it into a lucrative business. She and the father transitioned into entrepreneurship, though neither had prior business experience. Their initial success resulted in financial gain, but led to conflicts over money, highlighting the stress associated with wealth.

## Life Changes

Following a divorce, the author and her father found themselves without many material possessions or job prospects. They embraced a simple lifestyle, living off their

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remaining resources and enjoying the freedom from employment, which the author views as true luxury. They began to refer to their lifestyle as "possum living," reflecting a playful acceptance of simplicity and independence, in contrast to conventional working life.

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## Critical Thinking

Key Point:The challenge of abandoning materialistic society

Critical Interpretation:The chapter illustrates the allure of a minimalist lifestyle as proposed through Diogenes, but it invites readers to scrutinize its practicality in modern society. While Dolly Freed's family's journey to simplicity seems liberating, it's worth questioning whether such a lifestyle can sustain everyone, especially given varying financial realities and societal norms. Critics may point to sources like 'Your Money or Your Life' by Vicki Robin and Joe Dominguez, which discusses financial independence but also emphasizes responsible planning, suggesting that completely rejecting conventional jobs could lead to instability rather than genuine freedom.

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**inspiration**

Key Point:Embrace Simplicity

Life inspiration:Imagine shedding the weight of unnecessary possessions, feeling lighter and more free as you embrace a simpler lifestyle. Just as Diogenes found richness in minimalism, by focusing on what truly matters—relationships, experiences, and personal freedom—you might uncover a profound sense of joy and fulfillment. When you let go of the rat race and the constant quest for more, you might find that life opens up in unexpected ways. Embrace simplicity not just as a philosophy, but as a way to reclaim your time and energy for the moments that matter most, living abundantly with less.

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# Chapter 3 Summary : 2. The Cost of Living

| Section | Details |
|---|---|
| Year | 1976 |
| Normal Standard Cost | $5,500 annually (Estimated for a family of four) |
| Author's Family Expenditure | $1,498.75 annually |
| Financial Simplicity | Partially uncivilized living |
| Societal Pressure | Comparison to higher earners and "keeping up with the Joneses" |
| Expense Breakdown | Food: $268.89<br>Moonshine ingredients: $98.37<br>Soap and paper products: $47.45<br>Fuel oil: $161.66<br>Cooking gas: $87.01<br>Electricity: $101.24<br>Home improvement material: $335.43<br>Property taxes: $286.00<br>Clothing: $13.33<br>Luxuries: $25.05<br>Other (tools, laundry, fish hooks, etc.): $74.32 |
| Total Expenditure | $1,498.75 |
| Recurring Expenses | Excluding home improvement, essential costs are $1,163.33 |

## The Cost of Living

In 1976, the estimated cost for a family of four to maintain a "Normal Standard of Civilized Decency" was reported to be $5,500 annually, according to a government source. The author contrasts this with their family's annual expenditure of

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about $1,498.75, suggesting that they live with a level of financial simplicity that might categorize them as partially uncivilized.

The chapter reflects on societal pressures regarding income, noting how individuals feel inadequate by comparing themselves to others who earn more. The notion of "keeping up with the Joneses" is presented as an endless and futile cycle. The author advises readers to find their personal financial balance between extremes—wealthy lifestyles and simple living.

The breakdown of the family's expenses reveals where their money goes:

- Food: $268.89
- Moonshine ingredients: $98.37
- Soap and paper products: $47.45
- Fuel oil: $161.66
- Cooking gas: $87.01
- Electricity: $101.24

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# Chapter 4 Summary : 3. Income

| Section | Summary |
|---|---|
| Easy Ways to Earn Extra Money | Simple income methods include babysitting, housework, selling crafts, surplus plants, yard work, and handyman jobs. |
| Temporary Work and Craft Sales | The father does temporary work and crafts like candles but opts out due to past issues. Quality crafts marketed well can sell effectively; however, consignment and flea markets yield lower profits. |
| Marketing Strategies for Crafts | Promote crafts via personal connections and home parties; these can generate additional orders for both the seller and hostess. |
| Sales Tax Considerations | Be careful with sales tax collection when selling crafts; it's advisable to avoid it if unregistered but to handle inquiries politely. |
| Cost and Pricing | Starting a craft business is low-cost, but prices should cover time and materials. Handmade items can command higher prices if they are of premium quality. |
| Alternative Income Sources and Independence | Explore non-traditional income methods and embrace a minimalist lifestyle for personal freedom; use resourcefulness to meet needs over cash reliance. |

## Income Strategies

## Easy Ways to Earn Extra Money

The author shares simple methods to earn a little income, such as babysitting, housework for neighbors, and creating packaged craft items for a friend’s shop. Selling surplus plants and doing yard work or handyman jobs are also effective.

## Temporary Work and Craft Sales

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The father occasionally engages in temporary work for Manpower and has found that making and selling candles can be lucrative. However, the family avoids it due to past experiences. Craft sales can be successful with quality products and good marketing, but selling through consignment and flea markets often yields minimal profits.

**Marketing Strategies for Crafts**

Promoting crafts effectively includes leveraging personal connections, such as having a family member showcase items at work or hosting home parties for demonstrations. Successful home parties can lead to orders, benefiting both the hostess and the seller.

**Sales Tax Considerations**

When selling crafts, be cautious about collecting sales tax. It’s suggested to avoid it if not registered, but be prepared to handle inquiries about tax collection politely.

**Cost and Pricing**

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Starting a craft business can be inexpensive, but pricing should reflect time and expenses. Handmade items often justify higher prices compared to store-bought options, especially if they are of superior quality.

**Alternative Income Sources and Independence**

The author encourages exploring ways to earn without traditional employment and suggests that learning to live with less money can lead to greater personal freedom. Using resourcefulness to meet needs rather than relying on cash is advocated.

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**inspiration**

Key Point:Embrace Resourcefulness for Personal Freedom

Life inspiration:Imagine waking up each day with the freedom to choose how you want to earn money and live your life, just like Dolly Freed outlines in her chapter on income strategies. By embracing the mindset of resourcefulness and creativity, you can uncover countless ways to generate income without being tied down by traditional employment. Think about leveraging your unique skills, whether that's crafting beautiful handmade items, offering your services for yard work, or even babysitting for neighbors. Each small, independent venture becomes a stepping stone toward a life where you’re not just surviving, but thriving with less dependency on a conventional paycheck. This approach encourages you to rethink your relationship with money and pushes you to explore new avenues that resonate with your passions and talents, ultimately leading to a more fulfilling and liberated existence.

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# Chapter 5 Summary : 4. We Rassle with Our Consciences

## Summary of Chapter 5: We Rassle with Our Consciences

### Living Simply vs. Ideology

The author clarifies that their lifestyle choice is not ideologically driven; rather, it's a practical decision to simplify life and minimize the need for money. They express skepticism towards those who pursue similar lifestyles for ideological or esoteric reasons, suggesting that such approaches can lead to pretentiousness.

### Embracing Laziness

Dolly and her partner embrace a lifestyle of laziness, free from societal norms and pressures to conform to traditional work ethics. They share household duties not based on gender roles but on personal preferences, allowing for

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flexibility and anarchy in their daily lives. They challenge the societal stigma associated with laziness, finding value in living simply without the need for status or wealth.

**The Myth of Job Security**

Dolly reflects on societal expectations surrounding employment and job security. She notes that many people take pride in traditional employment while secretly resenting it. The author argues that worrying about future security is unmanly and contrary to Christian teachings, advocating instead for living in the moment.

**Contribution to Society**

Contrary to the belief that her lifestyle is unproductive, Dolly asserts that she does contribute positively by avoiding economic and environmental burdens. She emphasizes the importance of having children and an extended family structure, proposing that traditional family dynamics are more beneficial than institutionalized solutions like retirement homes.

**Questioning Societal Values**

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Dolly encourages readers to evaluate whether the money economy or possum living resonates with them. She stresses the necessity of family support and instinct in making such lifestyle choices. If conventional living feels right, she advises sticking with it; if not, exploring alternative lifestyles may be worthwhile.

**Practical Guidance for Simplifying Life**

The chapter concludes with a practical invitation to readers to transform their lives using available resources, advocating for a gradual shift towards less consumption and more self-sufficiency. Emphasis is placed on personal experimentation and finding what works for individual circumstances.

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## Critical Thinking

Key Point:Rejecting Ideological Labels for Practical Choices

Critical Interpretation:Dolly Freed posits that her lifestyle is a personal, practical escape from societal pressures rather than a belief-driven ideology, which raises questions about the validity of equating lifestyle choices with ideology. While Freed offers a refreshing perspective that values individual practicality over social pretentiousness, it invites readers to scrutinize the implications of dismissing ideological motivations entirely. It's crucial to consider whether one's choices, even if practical, might still undoubtedly reflect deeper socio-ideological contexts or privilege that could influence their applicability to broader societal dynamics. Scholars like Pierre Bourdieu in "Distinction: A Social Critique of the Judgment of Taste" can provide further insights into how social factors shape individual choices, underscoring that practicality and ideology can be interwoven rather than mutually exclusive.

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**inspiration**

Key Point:Embracing Laziness as Liberation

Life inspiration:Imagine stepping off the relentless treadmill of societal expectations, where the pressure to conform to traditional work ethics has dictated your worth for far too long. Picture a life where you redefine productivity on your own terms, allowing for moments of stillness and creativity to flourish in the space where 'laziness' once resided. By challenging the societal stigma around doing less, you open the door to genuine freedom that lets you explore who you are beyond a paycheck. Dolly Freed's philosophy reminds you that living simply can be a courageous act of rebellion against the status quo, empowering you to craft a life rich in meaning, comfort, and joy—unfettered by the chase for conventional success. As you consider your own journey, ask yourself: how can I embrace a more liberated, simplified existence, shedding the burdens of preconceived notions, to live a life that feels authentically mine?

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# Chapter 6 Summary : 6. Fish

## 6. Fish

### Overview of Fish Consumption

In various regions, fish is a primary food source. The author and her father enjoy fishing, managing to consume substantial quantities of various fish, including sunfish, bass, and catfish.

### Fishing Conditions and Techniques

Local water bodies have fishing restrictions, so they fish discreetly. They acknowledge the benefits of being near saltwater and reminisce about the seafood in Florida, while also discussing freshwater options like trout and catfish. The author insists on the potential of "trash fish," such as carp, emphasizing that these fish can be delicious if properly cooked.

### Cultural Perspectives on Fish

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There is a contrast drawn between the disdain for certain fish (labeled as scavengers) and the high prices paid for other scavengers like crabs and lobsters. The author encourages learning to cook lesser-known fish varieties and highlights the irony of overlooking significant protein sources in favor of commercially popular fish.

## Catching Techniques

The text stresses efficient fishing techniques, with various baiting strategies depending on fish behavior and environmental conditions. Observing fish feeding patterns, such as at sundown or after rain, is crucial. Unconventional and often illegal methods for catching fish are humorously noted, from snatching fish using treble hooks to unconventional fishing with pistols.

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# Chapter 7 Summary : 7. Gardening

| Section | Description |
|---|---|
| Introduction to Gardening | Accessible and does not require advanced skills; be cautious of inaccuracies in gardening literature. |
| Mulch Gardening Insights | Can attract pests like rats and slugs; consider alternative methods and trash burning instead of digging refuse into the soil. |
| Composting Techniques | Effective composting can be accelerated with animal waste such as rabbit and chicken manure. |
| Planting Strategies | Start planting from mid-February to September; use diverse areas and consider perennials like asparagus. |
| Growing Culinary Herbs | Easy to grow herbs like basil, thyme, and dill enhance dishes with fresh flavor. |
| Cultivating Your Garden | Focus on proper drainage and deep soil for healthy roots; organic gardening requires practical wisdom. |
| Foraging Essentials | Can supplement diets with edible plants like yellow rocket and wild ginger; not all weeds are viable food sources. |
| Wild Mushrooms | Identify safely with a reliable guide; some offer superior flavors compared to commercial options. |
| Conclusion | Combines creativity with practicality for sustainability and self-reliance through foraging and cultivation. |

## 7. Gardening

## Introduction to Gardening

Gardening is accessible and does not require advanced skills. While there are many gardening books, some may have inaccuracies, so use common sense when experimenting.

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## Mulch Gardening Insights

Mulch gardening can lead to problems like attracting rats or slugs. Opt for alternative materials or methods if pests are an issue. Consider burning refuse instead of digging it back into the soil to avoid pests.

## Composting Techniques

Composting is effective and can be accelerated by utilizing animal waste. Rabbit and chicken manure, along with decomposed matter like corncobs, can enrich the soil.

## Planting Strategies

Start planting as early as mid-February and continue into September. Use diverse planting areas to optimize growth based on climate variations. Consider perennial crops, like asparagus, which yield for years once established.

## Growing Culinary Herbs

Herbs such as basil, thyme, and dill are easy to grow and can significantly enhance meals. Fresh herbs are preferable over

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dried versions found in stores. They occupy little space and add valuable flavors to dishes.

## Cultivating Your Garden

Proper drainage and deep soil are essential for healthy plant roots. Methods for improving soil vary; consider your garden's specific conditions. Organic gardening should be approached with practical wisdom rather than extreme zeal.

## Foraging Essentials

Foraging can supplement diets, though not all weeds are viable for sustenance. Edible plants like yellow rocket and wild ginger can enhance meals without extensive preparation.

## Wild Mushrooms

Identifying edible mushrooms requires caution. A reliable guide is necessary to distinguish safe mushrooms from poisonous varieties. Some wild mushrooms can offer superior flavors compared to commercial ones.

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## Conclusion

Gardening combines creativity with practicality, offering food sustainability and enjoyment. Engaging with the local environment through foraging and cultivation enhances self-reliance.

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# Chapter 8 Summary : 8. Grain

## Grain Prices and Sources

Many people are unaware that human food can be purchased at feed-and-grain stores. Common items include potatoes, wheat, soybeans, and rolled oats, with a fifty-pound bag of rolled oats lasting about two years. It is advised to specify that wheat is for human consumption, as the price at feed stores is significantly cheaper than traditional grocery stores.

## Cost Comparison of Wheat

Retail wheat costs around $4.20 per bushel (7¢ per pound), while grocery store options, such as Ralston Wheat Cereal and Wheaties, show price increases ranging from 571% to 971%.

## Homemade Bread Using Wheat

With a home grinder costing about $19, the investment pays for itself quickly. Ground wheat is used for making breakfast cereals and wheaten cakes. For sandwich bread, a mix of

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white flour and wheat is used to create a quick dough.

**Utilization of Soybeans**

Soybeans, priced at approximately $7.80 per bushel (13¢ per pound), serve as a protein source both for bunnies and humans. They can be sprouted for vegetable dishes or made into soy snackies.

**Soy Snackies Preparation**

To make soy snackies, soak soybeans overnight, rinse, fry them until dark brown, and add soy sauce.

**Potatoes from Feed Stores**

Potatoes bought from feed stores are often less expensive and labeled as “seed potatoes,” which are still suitable for cooking. They can be used in dinner rolls, which remain fluffy and flavorful without requiring extra yeast.

**Potato Rolls Recipe**

To make potato rolls, combine mashed potatoes, water,

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powdered milk, margarine, salt, sugar, and flour, then add yeast. The dough is kneaded, allowed to rise, shaped, and baked, resulting in light and chewy rolls.

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# Chapter 9 Summary : 10. Preserving Food

## Preserving Food

### Overview of Food Preservation

In spring, summer, and autumn, food is abundant and does not require preservation. However, in winter, various methods are used to preserve foods such as drying, pickling, and canning.

### Dried Foods

-
**Dried Apples**
: Core, slice, and steam apples. Dry on screens in a warm, dry place until springy. Store in sealed jars.
-
**Dried Mushrooms**
: Separate caps and stems, dry on screens in a non-breezy

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area. Store in jars and reconstitute by soaking in warm water.

-

**Dried Herbs**

: Herbs like marjoram and thyme dry well. Store dried herbs in jars.

**Pickled Foods**

-

**Pickled Herbs**

: Pack tarragon or basil leaves in vinegar. After several days, use leaves and vinegar in dressings.

-

**Pickled Okra**

: Prepare okra pods with a pickling solution and process in water bath for preservation.

-

**Pickled Vegetables**

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# Chapter 10 Summary : 11. Nutrition

## Nutrition

At present, there is an overwhelming amount of information regarding nutrition, much of it driven by commercial interests. The author expresses skepticism about health food trends, highlighting that those who engage in "possum living" often adopt a health-conscious mindset, yet they shouldn't rely on buying health products.

The author shares a personal anecdote about health-conscious individuals who, despite their strict organic diets, struggled physically during manual labor, questioning the effectiveness of their supposed "super health."

The text critiques the marketing of supplements, noting that many athletes have not seen performance improvements from them. An example is given of a company promoting its products while ignoring those who perform poorly, casting doubt on the claims made.

The author points out contradictions in nutritional advice, such as the claim that green vegetables are essential, despite populations (like the Eskimos) thriving without them. The suggestion is made that individuals should trust their

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instincts and common sense regarding nutrition, emphasizing a balanced diet with whole, unprocessed foods.

In conclusion, for those practicing possum living and consuming a variety of wholesome foods, there is no need for special diets or expensive health foods, as their nutritional needs are naturally met.

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# Chapter 11 Summary : 12. The “Necessities of Life”

## Chapter 11 Summary: Necessities of Life

### Overview of Alcohol Production

The chapter opens with an old Appalachian saying about the challenges of obtaining essential resources, particularly clean drinking water. The author emphasizes that, with common sense, homemade alcohol can be safe to drink and even superior to commercial products. The text warns of misinformation surrounding alcohol production and highlights the importance of understanding the processes involved.

### Glossary of Key Terms

A glossary is provided to clarify essential terms related to winemaking and distillation, including:
- Baker’s yeast

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- Distillation
- Fermentation
- Moonshine
- Spirits

## Health Aspects of Drinking

The author discusses the health implications of consuming ethyl alcohol, affirming that the source—commercial or homemade—does not inherently determine safety. Anecdotes about personal experiences with home-produced alcohol versus commercial liquors illustrate its perceived safety and quality.

## Reasons for Home Alcohol's Bad Reputation

Four main concerns about home-produced alcohol's reputation include:
1. Consumption of dangerous denatured alcohol.
2. Use of harmful materials in distillation equipment.
3. Off-flavors due to off-fermentation, particularly fusel oil.
4. The misconception that high prices reflect higher quality.

## Yeast and Its Importance

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The chapter elaborates on the role of yeast in alcohol production, describing the symbiotic relationship between yeast and humans.

**Baker's yeast**

and

**wine yeast**

are discussed, noting their variances in efficiency and alcohol production capacity.

## Sugars as Fermentation Sources

Different sources of sugar for fermentation are explored, including fruits and refined sugar. A list of common fruits with their sugar content is provided, aiding readers in understanding the considerations required when making homemade alcohol. The ease and cost-effectiveness of using white sugar are highlighted, while also assessing the practicality of growing sugar beets.

## Conclusion

Overall, the chapter promotes the understanding of alcohol production, the necessary precautions, and the relationship

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between yeast and sugar, thereby enabling individuals to safely engage in making their own alcoholic beverages.

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# Chapter 12 Summary : 13. Housing

| Section | Summary |
|---|---|
| Housing | Housing is essential for financial independence, with outright home ownership offering security and freedom, allowing for personal growth without financial pressures. |
| Inexpensive and Adequate Housing | Affordable housing is attainable but may require effort to find. Prioritizing home ownership over other investments is crucial for stability. |
| Low-Cost Housing Options | Non-traditional housing options such as abandoned buildings and churches can serve as affordable alternatives. Good relations with neighbors are important to avoid zoning issues. |
| Buying a Home through Foreclosure Sales | The process of participating in foreclosure sales involves researching property values and debts. Being cautious and financially prepared is key to bidding successfully. |
| Home Repairs and Improvements | While home repairs often require permits, the author suggests self-repair to avoid bureaucracy and potentially save money, sharing personal success stories. |
| Property-Tax Assessments | Before renovations, individuals should assess property taxes, which may be overestimated. Comparing properties and discussing with assessors can help lower taxes. |
| Conclusion | The chapter emphasizes home ownership as a path to financial independence, offering practical advice on housing options, foreclosure sales, repairs, and tax management. |

## Housing

Housing is crucial for achieving a lifestyle of financial independence, referred to as "possum living." Renting or having a mortgage ties individuals to the money economy, while owning a home outright provides security and freedom. The author emphasizes that a secure home allows for a leisurely approach to life, enabling personal growth without the pressures associated with financial instability.

## Inexpensive and Adequate Housing

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The author notes that affordable housing can be found, although it often requires effort to locate. Many people are trapped in a cycle of needing a job to afford a home, preventing them from exploring better housing options. It is highlighted that owning a home should be prioritized over other investments, such as funding a college education for children.

**Low-Cost Housing Options**

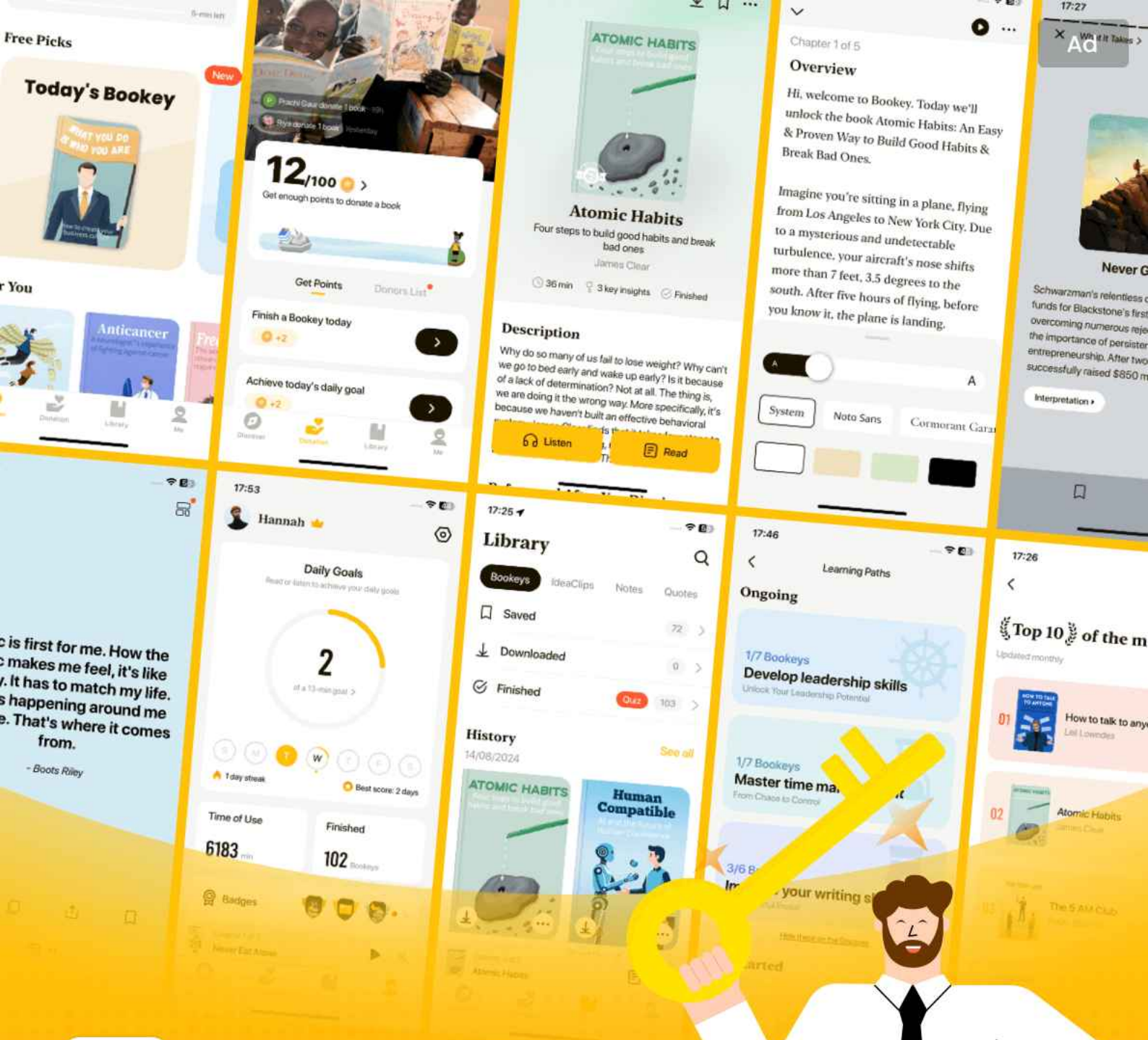
Various non-traditional housing options may provide affordable alternatives, such as abandoned buildings, grain elevators, and churches. The author details some personal experiences with acquiring such properties, emphasizing the importance of being discreet and maintaining good relations with neighbors to avoid zoning issues.

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# Chapter 13 Summary : 14. Heating

## Heating Strategies

### Oil Burner Transition

The author currently uses an oil burner inherited with the house but plans to replace it with a wood burner in the near future. A homemade wood burner has already reduced oil consumption by about half.

### Wood Burner Construction

The wood burner was constructed using inexpensive materials, primarily sourced from discarded items. Basic components cost around $15, while other parts were salvaged, demonstrating resourcefulness in creating a functioning heating system at minimal expense.

### Humidity Restoration

An advantage of the homemade stove is its ability to restore

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moisture to the air, contrasting with other systems that can excessively dry indoor air.

## Fuel Acquisition

Fuel for the wood burner is readily available through local waste disposal, neighborly generosity, and natural resources. The author utilizes basic tools for gathering and preparing wood.

## Future Solar Heating Plans

The author intends to explore solar heating by constructing a system using a south-facing wall and copper pipes, aimed at enhancing energy efficiency.

## Insulation Challenges

The house’s poor insulation presents challenges for heating. The author mitigates heat loss by closing off unneeded rooms and insulating windows, promoting a more comfortable living space.

## Thermostat Management

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A thermostat is maintained at 60°F, and the oil furnace is turned off during the night and when the house is unoccupied, supporting cost reduction in fuel usage.

**Debunking Heating Myths**

The author argues against common misconceptions regarding the costs of turning off the heat at night, advocating for lower energy expenditures by allowing the indoor temperature to drop gradually.

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# Chapter 14 Summary : 15. Electricity

## Electricity as a Resource

Electricity is considered a valuable resource, yet it's important to remember that it is not essential for life. Many people have lived without electricity, particularly in communities like the Amish who choose to avoid it for religious reasons.

## Usage and Costs

The author reports using about 230 kilowatt-hours bi-monthly at a cost of $16, primarily for essential appliances like water pumps and heating. The refrigerator is used sparingly, with measures taken to conserve energy, such as insulating the door and storing perishables outside in colder weather.

## Conscious Consumption

The author emphasizes the importance of minimizing electricity usage not just for cost savings but also as a stance

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against the demand for nuclear power. They argue that using many electric appliances contradicts opposition to nuclear power.

**Future Considerations**

The possibility of adopting wind power is acknowledged, but the author prefers to wait until technology advances and prices decrease.

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# Chapter 15 Summary : 16. Clothing

## Clothing and Consumerism

## Prestige and Status through Clothing

The author discusses how clothing is often used as a means to convey prestige, particularly among women. Through observations from a past job, the author notes that women frequently purchase expensive clothing not out of necessity, but to impress others. This social behavior includes conspiring to mislead their husbands about the costs of their purchases.

## Thrift Shop Solution

In contrast to the consumerist mentality, the author and her family rely on thrift shops for their clothing needs. They benefit from affordable prices at a local church thrift shop, with the author's father and herself spending only $10 and $15, respectively, on their entire wardrobes excluding footwear.

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## Changing Perceptions

The author defends their thrift shop style, asserting that she is attractive and presentable despite the low-cost origins of her clothing. Similarly, her father is described as looking decent when he makes an effort, countering the stereotype of thrifted clothing being dowdy.

## Cycle of Clothing Disposal

The text also addresses why high-fashion clothing often ends up in thrift shops: women who purchase new outfits must clear out space in their closets, and changing body sizes lead to unwanted items being donated. The author mentions that buying clothes is often more economical than making them, especially regarding children's clothing, which is abundant in thrift shops due to rapid growth.

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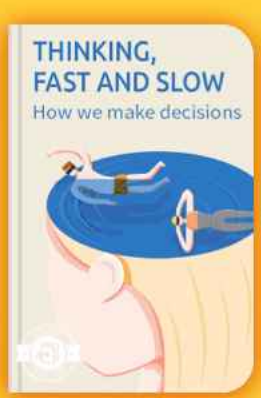
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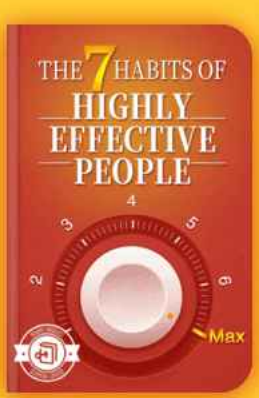
















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# Chapter 16 Summary : 17. Transportation

## Transportation

In modern society, cars are central to culture, symbolizing status and convenience. However, owning a car comes with numerous costs, including insurance, maintenance, and fuel expenses. In contrast, living without a car has presented some inconveniences, but it also encourages walking, running, and cycling, enhancing awareness of the surroundings.

## Alternative Transportation Methods

The author shares their experiences using bicycles as their primary mode of transport, advocating for three-speed bikes over ten-speed ones due to their practicality, ease of maintenance, and affordability. They emphasize the importance of buying used bikes at yard sales, while cautioning against purchasing potentially stolen merchandise.

## Challenges and Solutions

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One challenge is transporting heavy items, which they manage through a network of friends and occasional store deliveries. The author also mentions using a horse owned by a neighbor, highlighting the possibility of starting a horse boarding venture to facilitate transportation while generating income. This would provide access to horse transportation and manure for gardening.

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# Chapter 17 Summary : 18. Law

## Law and Personal Responsibility

### Overview of Trust in Government and Law

Dolly Freed reflects on her experiences and observations regarding the general distrust of government and the legal system among her social strata. Many avoid taxes and own weapons for protection, indicating a lack of faith in institutions.

### Understanding Your Rights

Freed emphasizes the importance of knowing one’s constitutional rights, advocating for individuals to learn and uphold them without unnecessary reliance on lawyers, whom she critiques as profit-driven.

### Navigating Legal Disputes Without Lawyers

She shares personal anecdotes that demonstrate how her

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family managed legal conflicts without legal representation. Her father engaged in direct negotiation, employing reasoning rather than resorting to formal legal mechanisms, which often lead to financial exploitation.

**Principles for Conflict Resolution**

Freed outlines her father's unofficial "rules" for dealing with adversaries:
- Ensure clarity in your goals and maintain focus on resolving the conflict rather than seeking revenge.
- Keep reactions measured and avoid threats to maintain strategic advantage.
- Use direct communication, but also leverage indirect methods to create pressure without escalating conflict.

**Ethical Considerations and Personal Agency**

While Freed acknowledges that her methods might be deemed questionable, she believes in the importance of personal agency and the pursuit of justice over legal formalities. She encourages individuals facing legal challenges to handle disputes proactively and to prioritize personal peace over bureaucratic processes.

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## Reflection on Legal Systems

Freed presents a critical view of the legal system as inherently flawed, suggesting that delays and complexities often hinder justice. She encourages finding resolutions independently and efficiently to alleviate stress, emphasizing the need for individuals to take charge of their situations.

## Conclusion

In a retrospective acknowledgment, Freed states that her views have evolved since writing, reflecting on the changes in her understanding of law and conflict resolution.

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## Critical Thinking

Key Point:The author's advocacy for navigating legal issues independently promotes personal empowerment but undermines systemic justice.

Critical Interpretation:Dolly Freed’s emphasis on self-reliance in resolving legal disputes highlights a crucial point regarding personal agency and the distrust in institutional support. While her experiences illustrate a desire for autonomy, it’s important to recognize that such an approach can inadvertently perpetuate existing inequalities in access to justice. Freed’s critique of lawyers as profit-driven may resonate with some, yet disregards the complexities of legal expertise that serve to protect individuals in a convoluted legal landscape. Moreover, engaging in self-representation can expose uninformed individuals to significant risks, ultimately leading to unfavorable outcomes. Scholars like Brian Tamanaha in 'Law as a Means to an End' might argue that the legal system, while flawed, is necessary to navigate societal conflicts fairly. Thus, while Freed's experiences are valid and evoke thoughtful analysis of the legal system, readers should consider the limitations of her perspective and the implications of minimizing

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professional legal representation.

# Chapter 18 Summary : 19. Health and Medicine

## Health and Medicine

### Overview of Modern Healthcare

Dolly Freed expresses gratitude for living in a time with advanced medical science that has eliminated many diseases. However, she highlights the substantial financial burden of healthcare in America, estimating an average annual expenditure of $547 per person, with rising costs projected. Freed argues that these figures are inflated by nonessential medical services and wonders what true essential care costs for healthy individuals.

### Personal Health Philosophy

Freed shares her and her father’s approach to health, emphasizing they do not spend on healthcare or rely on annual checkups. They have had minimal medical

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interventions and prioritize a healthy mindset. Freed observes that the fear of illness can be counterproductive and cites examples of individuals who embraced life rather than focus on health insurance and medical interventions.

### Exercise and Well-Being

Freed makes a clear distinction between work and exercise, asserting that running is preferable to jogging. She provides an exercise regimen aimed at promoting a vigorous lifestyle, particularly for young adults, while encouraging an attitude of intensity and excitement in physical activities.

### Home Remedies and Health Tips

Freed humorously shares her homemade remedies for common ailments, mostly involving herbal solutions and moonshine.

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# Chapter 19 Summary : 20. Daily Living

## Daily Living

### What Leisure-Niks Do

Leisure-niks often face the challenge of filling their days without the structure of a job. While some may find boredom problematic, the author, Dolly, argues that it can be managed and is sometimes part of life. Unlike many, her family doesn't own a TV, preferring to engage in outdoor activities and socializing. Despite periods of boredom during harsh winters, they maintain a fulfilling life of friends, recreation, and work.

### Autumn

During autumn, the family works about five hours a day, blurring the lines between work and leisure. They enjoy harvesting, fishing, bird watching, and playing badminton, interspersed with food preservation tasks as they prepare for winter. A poem captures the spirit of autumn, highlighting

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the enjoyment of the season.

**Winter**

Winter poses challenges, particularly with its cold, restricting outdoor activity. Daily tasks are reduced to two hours, focusing on chores. To combat boredom, they engage in math, play games, read, and practice music. They also begin planning their spring garden despite the wintry conditions.

**Spring**

Spring is the busiest season, filled with gardening, fishing, and birdwatching, merging work with enjoyment. Garden care and harvesting become central activities, connecting family routines with the joys of nature.

**Summer**

Summer mornings are filled with outdoor activities, gardening, and leisurely meals. The family embraces a relaxed lifestyle, incorporating exercise with play and social interactions, enjoying swimming and fishing as well.

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## Future Aspirations

Dolly expresses a desire to maintain the freedom of choice that comes with their lifestyle. She contemplates future adventures, like a year-long journey by boat, reflecting on how their experience has empowered them to embrace life beyond societal expectations.

## Conclusion

The text emphasizes the feasibility of a life lived more simply, encouraging others to pursue hobbies and interests more seriously, asserting that such changes can be made with ease.

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**inspiration**

Key Point:Embracing Simplicity in Daily Life

Life inspiration:Consider how you can cultivate a lifestyle that values simplicity and purpose over societal expectations. By consciously choosing to foster hobbies and engage with nature, as Dolly Freed describes, you can fill your days with meaningful activities that enrich your soul and promote well-being. Instead of feeling pressured by the relentless pace of modern life, imagine savoring each moment, whether you're gardening, fishing, or simply enjoying a quiet evening with loved ones. This shift in perspective invites you to see the beauty in boredom and the joy in creating a routine that reflects your values. Ultimately, it encourages you to embrace a fulfilling life where leisure and work dance harmoniously together.

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# Chapter 20 Summary : Nine More Years of Tried and True Lessons

## Nine More Years of Tried and True Lessons

### Possum Living as a Sliding Scale

Possum living varies from full to partial engagement, allowing for flexibility based on personal circumstances. Currently, the author practices a mix of frugality, cooking, and gardening while also maintaining a car and pets.

### Adapting to Change

Aging impacts capabilities, necessitating adaptations in lifestyle. The author adjusted her gardening approach by collaborating with others, turning her garden into a community space, enriching her life and relationships in the process.

### Affordable Housing Solutions

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Housing costs are rising, but alternatives like shared living and community gardens exist. The author shares her experience of creating a multi-generational household, emphasizing the importance of open communication regarding shared living arrangements.

**The Importance of Emergency Funds**

Having an emergency fund is vital for financial stability and can be life-saving. Personal anecdotes illustrate the importance of having savings, both for unexpected situations and supporting children's education without accruing debt.

**Value of Cooking**

Cooking is essential for health and finances. The author stresses the importance of cooking at home for personal well-being and shares resources for learning how to cook better.

**Advantages of Used Cars**

The author advocates for purchasing used vehicles,

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recounting a humorous yet enlightening story of a van incident that illustrates the advantages of frugality and resourcefulness.

**Prioritizing Possum Time**

Regardless of how fully one engages in possum living, it is crucial to carve out time for personal interests and relaxation, referred to as "possum time," to enhance life’s enjoyment.

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## Critical Thinking

Key Point:Possum Living as a Lifestyle Approach

Critical Interpretation:Dolly Freed presents 'possum living' as a viable lifestyle choice that encourages frugality and self-sufficiency, suggesting that individuals can thrive by minimizing reliance on traditional systems while fostering community ties. However, this viewpoint may oversimplify the complexities of modern life; not everyone has the flexibility or resources to adopt such a minimalist approach successfully, especially considering varying socioeconomic circumstances. Critics argue that while frugality and self-sufficiency are commendable, they may not be feasible for all, as highlighted in works such as 'Your Money or Your Life' and 'The Tightwad Gazette' which explore broader financial realities. Readers should critically assess how personal situations, societal structures, and economic factors influence one's ability to implement the ideals of 'possum living'.

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# Best Quotes from Possum Living by Dolly Freed with Page Numbers

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## Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 11-13

1. Many people, perhaps you among them, are not temperamentally suited for the 9-to-5 rat race but assume there is no other way to live.
2. We maintain a middle-class facade, and live well without a job or a regular income—and without working hard, either.
3. Each evening on the six o’clock news the economists... present it as being of cosmic significance.
4. My father and I produce most of our food and all of our drink (and fine food and drink they are, too, if I do say so myself) and spend only about $700 each per year.
5. Notice it says 'God,' not 'GNP.'
6. I hope to inspire you to do some independent thinking about economics as it affects the course of your individual life now and in the coming 'age of shortages.'

## Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 14-19

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1. People don’t own possessions, their possessions own them.
2. The gods gave man an easy life, but man has complicated it by itching for luxuries.
3. Why should this be? What did Diogenes do, besides live in a barrel, that anyone can’t do today?
4. Not having to make decisions is one of the great luxuries of life—right up there with not having to go to work.
5. Earning their way in life,” they call it. “Slavery,” I call it.
6. Let us do so even more.

## Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 20-22

1. Keeping up with the Joneses doesn’t work because the minute you pass the old Jones, a new one appears on the horizon. So why bother?
2. You wouldn’t want Howard Hughes’s money if you had to live Howard Hughes’s life, right?
3. There exists a niche of financial ambition somewhere between those two extremes that is just right for you. It’s up to you to decide where your niche lies.

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4.When I totaled up the figures and handed them to Daddy, his face went all white. Then he sat down and checked that his heart was still working okay. ‘Impossible!’ he shouted.

5.Take off that item and the budget reads $1,163.33.

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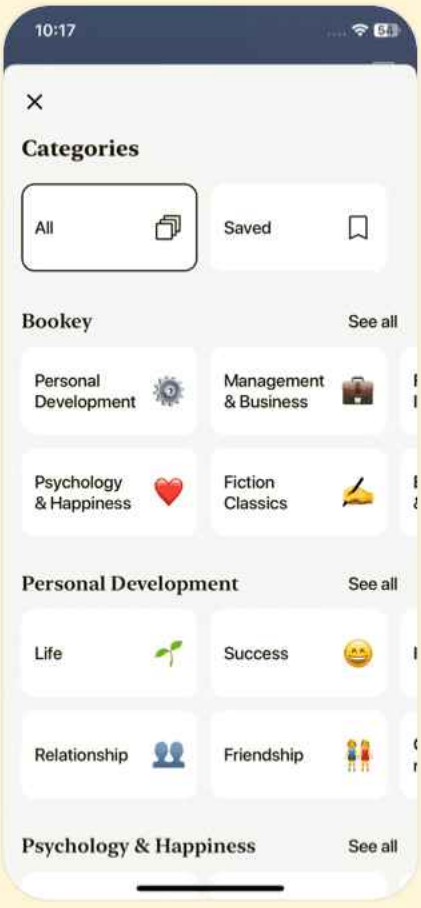
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## Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 23-27

1. There are so many ways to pick up money without actually (shudder) 9-to-5-ing, that whole books have been written on just that subject.
2. Much as I hate to admit it, you can really earn good money by making candles in your kitchen and selling them.
3. If you do try it, I hope you have enough sense to regard it as a business venture and don't get hung up on it as a hobby.
4. Being handmade, your item might be of higher quality than the store item, and if it is, you shouldn't be shy about charging a bit more.

## Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 28-36

1. We aren't a couple of Thoreaus mooning about on Walden Pond here. (...) We live this way for a very simple reason: It's easier to learn to do without some of the things that money can buy than to earn the money to buy them.
2. We're incredibly lazy. You wouldn't believe it! We have an

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anarchy here wherein neither has to do anything we don’t feel like doing.

3. You needn’t keep score either if you don’t want to. It’s entirely up to you.
4. I refuse to spend the first sixty years of my life worrying about the last twenty.
5. Possum economics allows for everybody to be useful and contribute to the well-being of the family, regardless of age.
6. You can always use me as a Bad Example!
7. Trust your instincts. "Philosophize with a hammer," as Nietzsche advocated, "testing idols to see if they ring true.

## Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 38-63

1. The truth is, if you cook them according to the usual cookbook instructions, you’ll soon learn why they’re called trash fish.
2. People worried about protein shortages are learning how to mix soybeans and grains together so they shouldn’t get amino acid deficiencies, while tons of high-quality

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protein—in the form of carp—swim about and are ignored.

3. When it comes to fishing, if they don't bite at one spot, go to another spot.
4. For every person actually mixing those soybeans and grains you get ten who learn to appreciate carp.
5. Some people will look at one of those hideous reptiles and remember they have an appointment to be not hungry when it's to be served up, and offer their regrets—which leaves all the more for us.
6. If you want to live right, go catch crayfish all of a summer's day.
7. Nothing to it.

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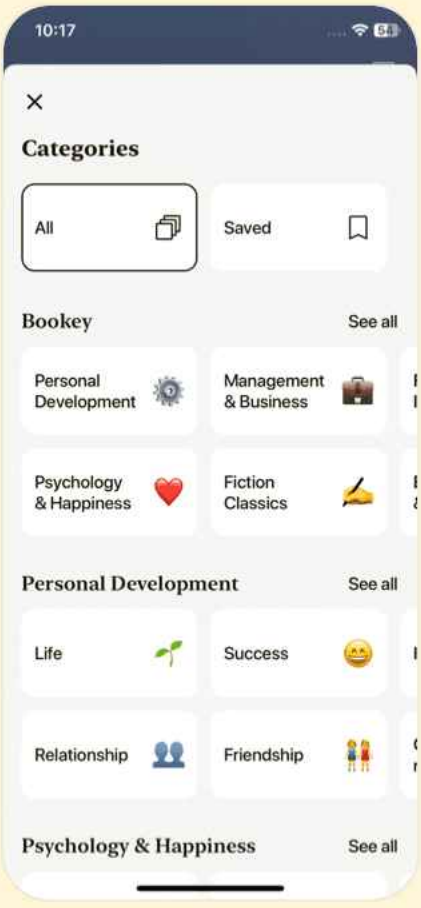
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## Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 64-87

1. Actually, mankind was successfully practicing agriculture even before metallurgy or writing, so how complicated can it be?
2. If you don't have rats or mice in your neighborhood, it might work for you.
3. If you must turn organic matter under, use leaves, grass, or corncobs that won't contain insects or weed seeds.
4. So go dig a garden, even if it must be in your front yard.
5. Don't plant it if you can't eat it.
6. You know it's summertime and the living is easy when you bite into corn fresh out of the garden!
7. There are many productive gardens in our area that were never trenched or worked more than eight inches deep.
8. We're organic gardeners ourselves, and for the most part believe in it, but not to the degree of fervor that some zealots work up.

## Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 88-94

1. Many people are not aware that human food is

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sold in feed-and-grain stores.

2. A fifty-pound bag lasts us about two years.
3. Wouldn’t you think someone would just crack some wheat and stick it in a box to sell for, say, 25¢ per pound?
4. We haven’t bought bread in the three years we’ve had our grinder.
5. The Roman army conquered the world on a diet largely of wheat.
6. You can really get taken buying soybeans at a health food store.
7. Why peel a potato that’s to be fried or boiled and mashed and not one that’s to be baked?
8. Two of their other virtues are that you can use up leftover mashed potatoes and that they are cheaper to make than other rolls.

## Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 97-105

1. Canning is not the big deal it’s made out to be, and if you can grow or get more food than you can use immediately, you should get into it.

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2.Fish (or other meat) can be easily preserved for at least several weeks by brining and smoking.

3.With practice you learn to judge when the fish are done by feeling their weight in your hand.

4.A little mold on the dried apples won’t hurt. We eat them as a snack. They don’t require reconstituting or any other preparation, so they’re possum convenience food.

5.The scales will also keep the grosser wood tars from getting to the meat. The smoke flavor will penetrate—the tar won’t.

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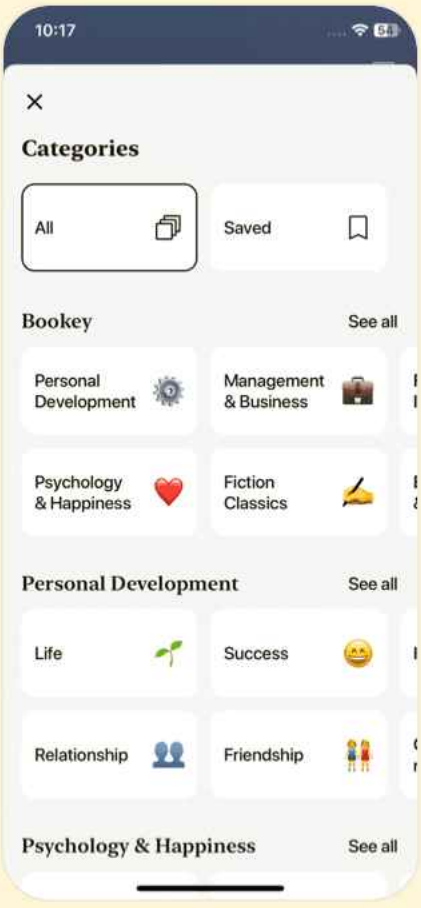
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## Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 106-109

1. If you can't believe the health hucksters, and you can't believe the respected authorities, whom can you believe? Why, you believe in your instincts and your common sense, of course.
2. If you're normal and healthy your body will tell you what it needs.
3. One of the nice things about possum living is that you do have time and energy to prepare and enjoy good food—you don't need to grab a cup of coffee and a doughnut and run.
4. If you're eating possum fodder (whole wheat bread, fish, garden fresh produce, etc.), you're bound to get all the nutrients you need without a special diet or spending a lot of money—so don't worry about it.

## Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 110-121

1. If you do decide to drink, however, I can assure you that it makes no difference whatsoever whether that ethyl was produced in a commercial operation or in your kitchen.

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2.There are four reasons why home-produced alcohol has a bad reputation: First there are those bums who drink denatured alcohol and go blind or worse.

3.Yeasts and humans have a true symbiotic relationship, I believe.

4.The reason commercial liquor costs about ten times what it costs to make moonshine has nothing to do with value.

5.Whatever the source of the sugar may be, it’s all subject to the same basic principles.

## Chapter 12 | Quotes From Pages 122-139

1.If you’re renting or paying off a mortgage, you are locked into the money economy, period. End of sentence.

2.Owning your own home free and clear—that’s the key to all the rest. Once you have your snug harbor, your safe base, all else comes easy.

3.If your family income is anywhere near average, you can scrimp and save and cut back for maybe two to four years and save up the capital to become free for the rest of your

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life.

4. When we read it, it completely amazed us. All that starvation, squalor, and general misery the Okies were forced to endure stemmed from only two roots: (1) the fact that they didn't own their homes outright, and (2) their mule-headed determination to rely on the money economy.
5. In some big cities they're practically giving away housing in the neighborhoods that are no longer fit to live in.
6. We had no prior experience in any related fields, either. We acquired a complete set of do-it-yourself books, read up carefully on each subject, and just jumped in with two feet and got the job done.

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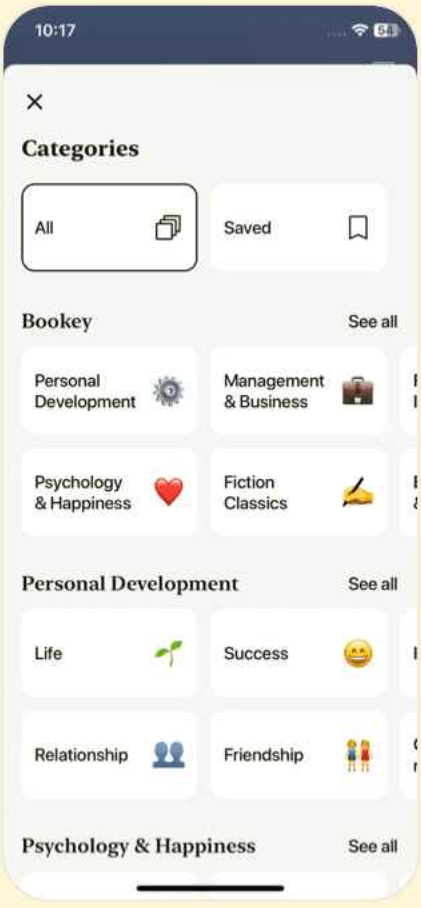
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## Chapter 13 | Quotes From Pages 140-143

1. We didn’t buy it, of course, we made it.
2. We are fortunate in having an almost blank wall facing south. We will paint this wall flat black, then build a system of copper pipes against the wall, and enclose it with glass held in wooden frames.
3. We keep the thermostat at 60°F... we turn off the oil furnace at night.
4. The BTUs lost through the walls are proportional to the temperature differential between the inside and outside.
5. Maybe someone should do a consumer report on the quality of consumer magazines.

## Chapter 14 | Quotes From Pages 144-145

1. Electricity is a real bargain when you consider what you get for your money.
2. Nevertheless, you do well to keep in mind that it isn’t essential for human life.
3. Millions upon millions of happy, healthy people lived satisfying lives without it.

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4.We also conscientiously use as little electricity as possible because ‘increasing demand’ is the justification for building nuclear power plants.

5.Of course, it’s not automatic defrost.

6.We will probably, at some future date, buy or build wind-powered generating equipment, but not yet.

## Chapter 15 | Quotes From Pages 146-147

1.The implementation of buying prestige and status is often through the medium of clothing.

2.Once when Daddy worked for Manpower he had a two-week job working for a business that sold fashionable women’s clothing.

3.The distinct impression was that they didn’t have as much need for clothing as they had to impress their friends and the saleslady with the size of the bundle they were dropping.

4.We get all our clothing at the thrift shop.

5.Well, I know what you’re thinking: I’m some poor, dowdy little thing and Daddy looks like the scarecrow from The

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Wizard of Oz.

6. The truth is that when I get dressed up I’m a knockout.
7. Okay, you say, how does all this fine clothing wind up in a thrift shop?
8. Children’s clothing is even more plentiful at thrift shops because, of course, children quickly outgrow their clothes.

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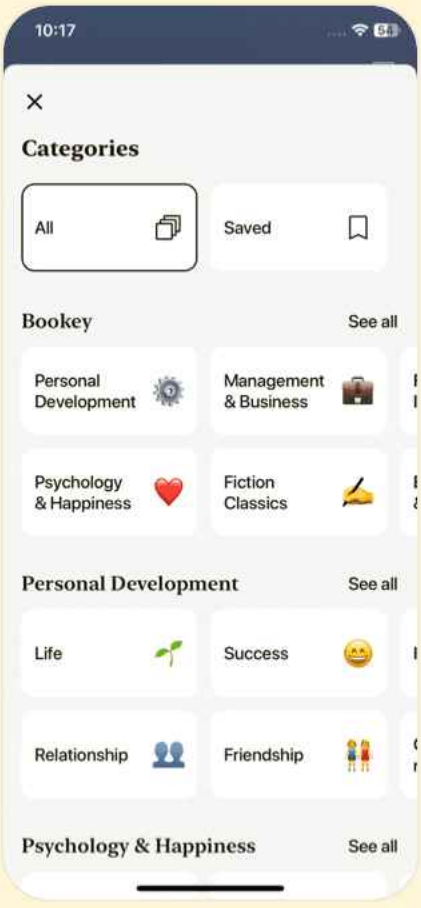
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## Chapter 16 | Quotes From Pages 148-150

1. To the suburbanite it has become what the horse was to the Plains Indians—the whole basis of the culture.
2. It doesn't seem to have harmed us. In fact, we enjoy it.
3. Walking or cycling, you really do notice a lot more about the things going on around you than you do from a speeding car, trite as that may sound.
4. Don't encourage thieving—your bike might be the next to disappear.
5. We're thinking of building a two-horse stable...we'd have the use of the animals for transportation, and the extra manure for the garden.

## Chapter 17 | Quotes From Pages 151-159

1. A society that requires honest people to hire other people to speak or write for them when they want to reach an agreement with others is a flawed society, I think.
2. You owe it to yourself to learn what your rights are, and to

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insist that they not be violated.

3.If you’re honest and fair, and know how to speak English, you should never need a lawyer.

4.What you must keep in mind is that many people, out of greed, have convinced themselves that it’s okay for them to do whatever they want so long as it’s strictly legal.

5.Justice is what all rational people want, and law is the substitute they are sometimes willing to accept.

## Chapter 18 | Quotes From Pages 160-170

1.These figures are somewhat misleading since they include such things as cosmetic plastic surgery, various vague therapies, dental braces, and other nonessential medical care.

2.Let’s grope our way out of this murky den. The first aspect of health is to have a healthy mind—a healthy outlook on life. If you have to go through life worrying about getting sick, what’s the sense of it?

3.He died like a man, in an athletic contest, rather than live an invalid’s life and slowly sputter out in some bleak

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hospital.

4. My guess would be that it would be something in the order of $20 a year (1976 dollars) over the person's lifetime.
5. You wouldn't really expect him to throw away his whole investment in his career just because it happens to be nonsense, would you?
6. I firmly believe that anyone leading a natural, healthy, unharassed life will come to find that life is purposeful and good.

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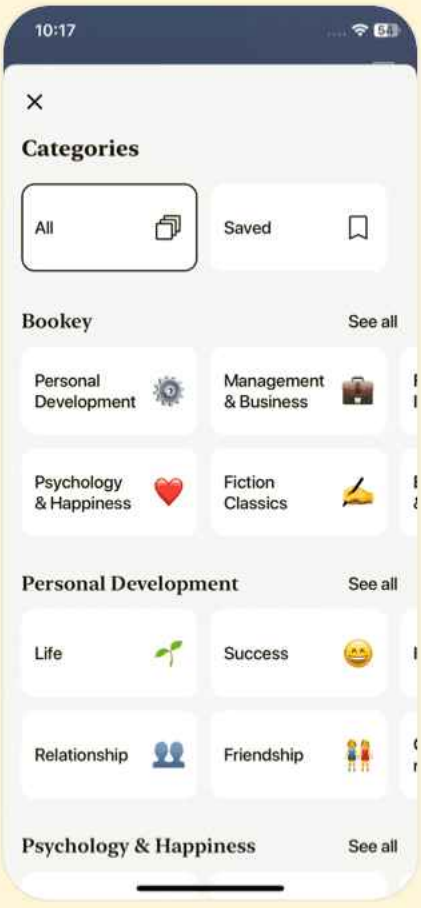
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## Chapter 19 | Quotes From Pages 171-182

1. Boredom is not to be underestimated. Murders, suicides, and even full-scale wars have come about from pure boredom.
2. We're not hermits and neither need you be if you take up this lifestyle.
3. Work and recreation can't be separated time-clockwise.
4. This freedom I harp on isn't restricted merely to whether or not to have a job.
5. Wouldn't you like to change these from merely recreation to partly occupation? Yes? Then why don't you simply do so?

## Chapter 20 | Quotes From Pages 202-210

1. Possum Living isn't an on or off way of living. It can be sliding scale from full possum to baby possum.
2. Having an emergency fund is essential.
3. If you can't agree on the use of common areas, put a strip of masking tape down the middle of the room like my

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brother and I did when we were sharing an attic.

4. When it sank in how much college costs had grown in the last few decades, we decided we didn’t want our kids to be indentured servants to the shark loan industry.
5. Take it from someone who’s been kicking around for a long time now: eating well is half the secret to a good life.
6. Set aside possum time to cook; to go fishing; to be with family, friends, and neighbors; to forage for wild berries; to enjoy a hobby; to relax; or, even better, to do nothing at all.

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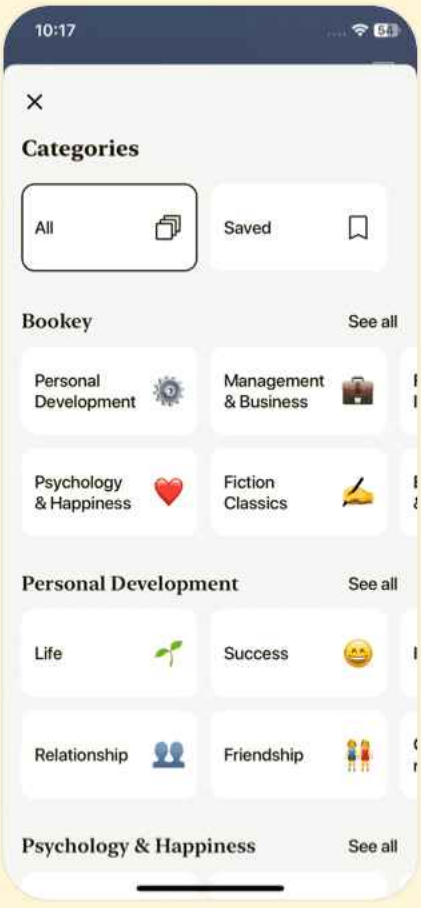
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# Possum Living Questions

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## Chapter 1 | An Introduction to Possum Living| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What does the author suggest about the traditional 9-to-5 work life?**

Answer:The author suggests that many people are not suited for the traditional 9-to-5 work life, yet they feel trapped within that system because they believe there is no alternative. This perspective encourages readers to explore different ways of living that don't depend on conventional employment.

### 2.Question

**How does the author view financial news and economic indicators?**

Answer:The author views financial news and economic indicators, such as inflation and unemployment rates, as irrelevant to their way of life. They believe that these factors

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don't dictate their well-being or happiness, emphasizing that humanity thrived for centuries without the current economic structures.

### 3.Question

**What is the main ingredient in the author's sense of well-being?**

Answer:The main ingredient in the author's sense of well-being is the ability to produce most of their food and drink, which allows them to live comfortably on a minimal budget, free from the pressures of the conventional money economy.

### 4.Question

**What attitude does the author have toward charity and welfare?**

Answer:The author has a critical attitude towards charity and welfare, indicating a desire for independence and self-sufficiency, rather than relying on governmental assistance, which they view as tied to societal constraints.

### 5.Question

**In what way does the author connect personal life with**

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**biblical principles?**

Answer:The author connects personal life with biblical principles by referencing Ecclesiastes 3:13, which underscores the idea that enjoying the fruits of one's labor is a divine gift, suggesting that true wealth comes from appreciating life's simple pleasures rather than material accumulation.

## 6.Question

**How does the author hope to inspire readers through this book?**

Answer:The author hopes to inspire readers to think independently about their economic choices and to consider alternative lifestyles that allow for greater freedom and fulfillment, especially in the context of potential future shortages.

## 7.Question

**What does the author mean by 'living well' without a traditional income?**

Answer:'Living well' in the author's context means being

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content and self-sufficient on a low budget, producing their food and drink, and enjoying life without the stress related to conventional financial pressures or societal expectations.

### 8.Question

**Why does the author believe their lifestyle is achievable for others?**

Answer:The author believes their lifestyle is achievable for others because they emphasize that they are not doing anything extraordinary, and that any reasonably able person can replicate their way of living by engaging with the resources around them in a thoughtful manner.

## Chapter 2 | 1. We Quit the Rat Race| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What can we learn from Diogenes about material possessions?**

Answer:Diogenes teaches us that material possessions can take control of our lives, and that true freedom comes from simplicity and a rejection of unnecessary luxuries. By living with only

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essentials, like Diogenes with his drinking cup and barrel, we can focus on more meaningful aspects of life rather than being burdened by things.

## 2.Question

**How did the author's family embody the principles of Diogenes?**

Answer:After embracing a simpler life, the author's family initiated austerity measures to reduce unnecessary expenses, mirroring Diogenes's principles. Despite initial struggles, they discovered skills and independence, showing that a fulfilling life doesn’t require conventional success or material wealth.

## 3.Question

**What lesson does the author draw about jobs and wealth?**

Answer:The author suggests that traditional jobs and the pursuit of wealth can lead to a form of slavery, where people are trapped by their need for money. Instead, they advocate for a lifestyle where one’s needs are met simply, with a focus on enjoyment and fulfillment rather than financial gain.

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## 4.Question

**How did the author’s family react to their newfound freedom after the divorce?**

Answer:The author and their father experienced a sense of liberation after the divorce, feeling unencumbered by the pressures of work or financial obligations. They enjoyed the simplicity of life without the complications of a job, illustrating the joy found in living authentically and without societal expectations.

## 5.Question

**What is 'Possum Living' as described by the author?**

Answer:'Possum Living' is a philosophy that advocates for simple, sustainable living, drawing inspiration from animals like possums that thrive without the need for conventional jobs or luxuries. It promotes the idea of living freely and contentedly, with minimal reliance on material possessions or societal pressures.

## 6.Question

**Why did the author's mother struggle with the lifestyle changes they adopted?**

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Answer:The author's mother struggled with the lifestyle changes because, after experiencing the success and excitement of running a business, she became attached to the idea of wealth and financial independence. This desire clashed with the simpler, more relaxed lifestyle that Diogenes would endorse, leading to conflict and ultimately her departure.

### 7.Question

**How did the author's father's perspective on life reflect a Diogenian attitude?**

Answer:The author's father embodied a Diogenian attitude by expressing contentment with their simple life, valuing freedom from the rat race over conventional success. His perspective that not making decisions can be a luxury parallels Diogenes's rejection of societal norms in favor of personal peace and simplicity.

## Chapter 3 | 2. The Cost of Living| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What was the perceived cost of living for a family of four in 1976 according to official sources?**

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Answer:Around $5,500 per year.

## 2.Question

**How much did the author's family of two actually spend in the same period?**

Answer:They spent about $1,498.75, which is one-fourth of the perceived cost.

## 3.Question

**What does the author suggest about societal expectations regarding income?**

Answer:The author critiques the constant comparison to others' incomes (keeping up with the Joneses), suggesting it's a futile pursuit.

## 4.Question

**What is the fundamental message conveyed through the author's budgeting example?**

Answer:The author encourages readers to find their own balance in financial ambition—neither extreme wealth nor poverty—by examining their spending and values.

## 5.Question

**How did the author's father react to the spending totals?**

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Answer:He was shocked and felt it was impossible, prompting a breakdown of expenses.

### 6.Question

**What is the significance of the item 'Home improvement material' in the budget?**

Answer:It represents a nonrecurring expense that enhances property value, indicating that such investments can be seen as saving rather than spending.

### 7.Question

**Based on the content, what does the author imply about living simply?**

Answer:Living simply may lead to less financial stress and a more meaningful existence, as shown by their low expenditures yet satisfaction.

### 8.Question

**What philosophical view does the author imply about choices and lifestyle?**

Answer:The author illustrates that the right financial lifestyle is subjective, and one should define their own 'niche' rather than adhering to societal pressures.

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## 9.Question

**Why is it important to break down expenses according to the author?**

Answer:Breaking down expenses can help in understanding spending patterns and making more informed decisions about financial priorities.

## 10.Question

**What can readers learn about the relationship between money and happiness from this chapter?**

Answer:The author suggests that money does not equate to happiness or civilization, advocating for personal contentment and financial awareness over societal benchmarks.

## 11.Question

**What life lesson can be drawn from the phrase 'You wouldn’t want Howard Hughes’s money if you had to live Howard Hughes’s life'?**

Answer:True wealth should be measured not just by financial means but by quality of life and personal happiness.

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## Chapter 4 | 3. Income| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is a productive way to earn money without committing to a traditional job?**

Answer:You can take up odd jobs in your neighborhood, such as babysitting, doing housework, yard work, or even temporary jobs through agencies like Manpower. Additionally, crafting and selling homemade items like candles, plants, or other crafts can generate income without a typical 9-to-5 job.

### 2.Question

**How can one successfully sell homemade crafts?**

Answer:To successfully sell homemade crafts, consider hosting parties or demonstrations where people can see your work firsthand and place orders. Utilize relationships with friends or family who can showcase your items at their workplaces. It's important to ensure quality and timely fulfillment of orders.

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## 3.Question

**What are some common pitfalls when selling crafts?**

Answer:Common pitfalls include consignment arrangements with shops which often don't work, as shopkeepers might not actively promote your items, and partnership deals that can lead to conflicts if personal relationships aren't managed well.

## 4.Question

**How can you creatively market your crafts without spending much on advertising?**

Answer:You can gain publicity for your crafts by reaching out to local newspapers or community pages, offering them a story or feature about your work. Additionally, you can provide free samples or host craft parties where attendees can see and order your products.

## 5.Question

**What is the best strategy when considering pricing for handmade items?**

Answer:Track your expenses carefully and consider how much time you spend making the items. Research

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comparable products in local stores to inform your pricing, and feel confident setting a price that reflects the higher quality of your handmade goods.

### 6.Question

**How does living without much money contribute to personal freedom?**

Answer:Learning to live without relying on money fosters self-sufficiency and independence. It allows you to create what you need rather than purchasing it, leading to a sense of liberation from common financial restrictions and the burden of traditional employment.

### 7.Question

**What should one keep in mind regarding taxes when selling crafts?**

Answer:It’s advised to avoid collecting sales tax unless you’re certain you will pay it. If questioned, you can simply state that you are in the process of obtaining a tax number to avoid complexities. Being upfront with your hostess about payment collection is also important for a smooth

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transaction.

### 8.Question

**Why might some crafts sell better than others according to the text?**

Answer:Certain crafts, like candles or quality jewelry, tend to sell better due to consumer interest and demand. The quality and uniqueness of the item, along with effective marketing, play significant roles in a craft's selling potential.

## Chapter 5 | 4. We Rassle with Our Consciences| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the primary motivation behind the author's lifestyle choices as described in this chapter?**

Answer:The author emphasizes that their lifestyle is not ideologically motivated but rather a practical choice to simplify life by learning to do without many conventional consumer goods, primarily because it's easier than trying to earn money to buy them.

### 2.Question

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**How does the author perceive laziness in society, and what is their stance on it?**

Answer:The author is proud of their laziness, asserting that society unfairly devalues it. They have cultivated a lifestyle where they do not feel compelled to adhere to the traditional Protestant Work Ethic and find value in their relaxed approach to life.

### 3.Question

**What does the author suggest about the value of prestige and status in relation to money?**

Answer:The author believes that while money can buy prestige and status, they personally do not feel the need for these societal markers. They draw inspiration from figures like Diogenes, who challenge the need to 'keep score' with wealth.

### 4.Question

**What alternative does the author propose regarding family living arrangements and societal norms?**

Answer:The author rejects the idea of conventional marriage

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or leaving their family home in favor of an extended family model where multiple generations live together, emphasizing that this structure fosters usefulness and continuity.

### 5.Question

**How does the author respond to criticism regarding their contribution to society?**

Answer:The author acknowledges the criticism but counters it by highlighting that although they don’t contribute to economic growth, they also avoid contributing to pollution and can serve as a 'bad example' to others, subverting societal expectations.

### 6.Question

**What philosophical stance does the author take on planning for the future?**

Answer:The author implies that worrying about future security is unmanly and counterproductive. They advocate living in the moment and not letting future fears dictate personal choices, aligning their thoughts with teachings from Jesus about not worrying about tomorrows.

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### 7.Question

**How does the author view the concept of 'possums' in relation to human existence?**

Answer:The author philosophizes that the life of a human can be viewed similarly to that of a possum, questioning the complexity and purpose people assign to their lives, and suggesting that the simplicity of existence is just as valid.

### 8.Question

**What is the overall message the author conveys about societal norms and individual choices?**

Answer:The author encourages readers to critically assess societal norms, trust their instincts, and pursue a lifestyle that brings them happiness, whether that means embracing a nonconsumer lifestyle or simply adopting some parts of it.

## Chapter 6 | 6. Fish| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the significance of eating 'trash fish' such as carp in terms of food sustainability?**

Answer:Eating trash fish, like carp, is significant for food sustainability because they are abundant in

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many water bodies and provide a high-quality protein source. Many people overlook them due to misconceptions about their taste and reputation. By learning to cook them properly, we can tap into a resource that helps alleviate potential protein shortages while reducing waste of a valuable food source.

## 2.Question

**How can the process of catching fish reflect one's approach to life's challenges?**

Answer:Catching fish, as described in the book, requires adaptability and persistence. If one spot yields no fish, a smart fisherman moves to another spot or changes bait. This mirrors life; when faced with challenges, adaptation, and trial and error often lead to success. It emphasizes the notion that persistence through experimentation leads to eventual rewards.

## 3.Question

**In what ways do the author's fishing methods highlight resourcefulness?**

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Answer:The author's fishing methods emphasize resourcefulness through the use of everyday items for bait and creative fishing techniques. By utilizing what is available—whether it’s natural bait like worms or unconventional methods like treble hooks—Dolly Freed illustrates that resourcefulness can help feed a family without relying on store-bought goods, reinforcing independence and self-sufficiency.

## 4.Question

**What does the writer say about preconceived notions regarding specific types of fish and their value?**

Answer:The writer challenges preconceived notions about certain fish, labeling many, like carp and catfish, as 'trash fish' due to poor preparation or societal biases. The author argues that with the right cooking techniques, these fish can be delicious and nutritious, thus highlighting the importance of perspective in appreciating food and resources otherwise overlooked or dismissed.

## 5.Question

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**How does fishing connect to the personal enjoyment and lifestyle choices of the author and their father?**

Answer:Fishing serves not just as a means to gather food but as a joyful activity that the author and her father cherish. Their adventures reflect a lifestyle choice grounded in enjoying nature and simple pleasures. This connection underscores a broader theme in the book about finding fulfillment and joy in self-sufficient living.

## 6.Question

**What safety measures does the author suggest when consuming fish from local waters?**

Answer:The author emphasizes cooking fish thoroughly to mitigate risks related to contamination, especially concerning parasites or pollutants. It’s a reminder that while local water sources may seem appealing, awareness and proper handling are crucial to ensure safety when consuming wild-caught fish.

## 7.Question

**What lessons can be drawn about societal beliefs regarding the value of different food sources?**

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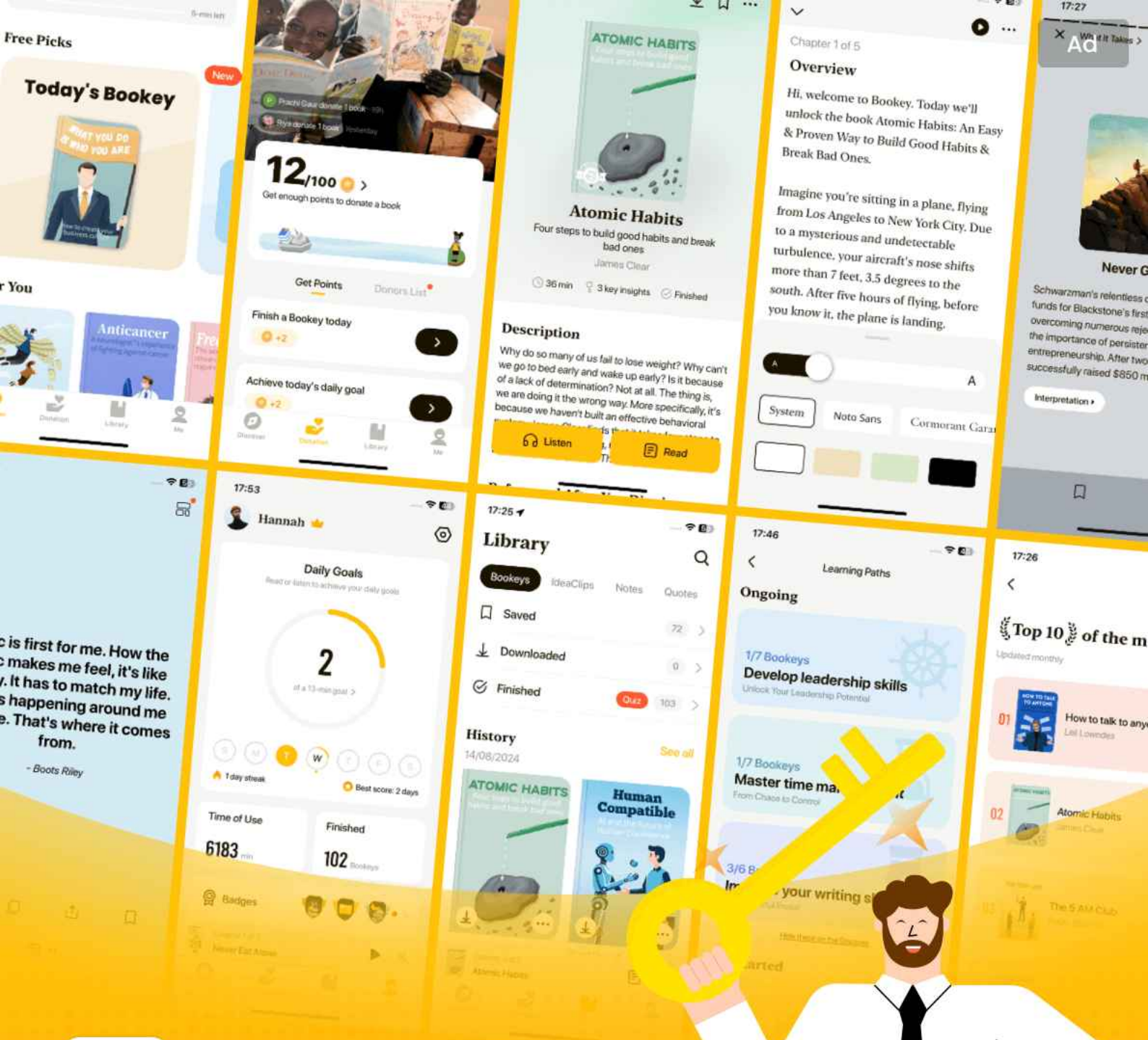
Answer:The lessons drawn on societal beliefs reveal that cultural perceptions often shape our dietary preferences and judgments about food sources. The author illustrates how these biases can lead to waste and missed opportunities by highlighting the nutritious potential of overlooked species like carp and catfish, advocating for a broader appreciation of diverse food sources.

## 8.Question

**How does the author’s perspective on fishing relate to the broader theme of self-sufficiency in 'Possum Living'?**

Answer:The author’s perspective on fishing is closely related to the theme of self-sufficiency in 'Possum Living' by demonstrating a practical skill that supports a lifestyle rooted in independence from commercial food systems. By cultivating fishing expertise and knowledge of local resources, the author embodies the essence of living off the land while promoting sustainability and resilience.

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## Chapter 7 | 7. Gardening| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the essence of successful gardening according to the author, and how can one avoid common pitfalls?**

Answer:The essence of successful gardening is simple and rooted in common sense. The author emphasizes that gardening isn't the complicated art it's often portrayed to be; humanity has been cultivating crops for millennia without modern complexities. To avoid pitfalls, gardeners should be wary of methods like mulch gardening that may introduce pests, such as rats or slugs, and understand the significance of composting, fertilizing properly, and using the right techniques for cultivating soil. Learning from others' experiences can help avoid mistakes.

### 2.Question

**How does the author suggest utilizing space effectively in a garden?**

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Answer:The author suggests utilizing space by planning the garden layout carefully to ensure maximum yield from limited space. For instance, crops like peas can be planted in succession with later plantings of corn or radishes before the season ends, allowing for two harvests from one area. Additionally, the author highlights growing herbs and fast-maturing plants to make the most out of available gardening space.

### 3.Question

**What benefits do herbs provide in gardening according to the author?**

Answer:Herbs provide numerous benefits; they require little space and care while offering fresh flavors far superior to dried, store-bought options. The author mentions experimenting with a variety of herbs, which can transform ordinary dishes and showcase diverse flavor profiles. Growing herbs also encourages creativity in cooking and enhances meals significantly.

### 4.Question

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**Why does the author believe it is important to grow your own vegetables?**

Answer:The author believes growing your own vegetables is essential because it allows for better flavor, freshness, and control over what you consume. This is especially significant for crops that may be costly or unsatisfactory when purchased at a store. Additionally, homegrown produce cultivates independence and self-sufficiency.

## 5.Question

**What perspective does the author offer about foraging and wild plants?**

Answer:The author encourages foraging, noting that while wild plants can add variety to the diet, they shouldn't be relied upon for survival like traditional crops. Certain weeds and wild edibles, such as yellow rocket and upland cress, are highlighted for their culinary potential, but the author stresses that gardeners may find it easier and more productive to cultivate their own food.

## 6.Question

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**How does the author's attitude toward commercial gardening methods compare to their personal gardening experiences?**

Answer:The author's attitude towards commercial gardening methods is skeptical; they advocate for a more hands-on approach grounded in practicality and personal experience. Although the author recognizes the merits of organic gardening, they caution against overzealous theories and suggest that personal observation and experience are more valuable than trendy gardening fads.

## 7.Question

**What is the significance of seed selection and storage in gardening according to the author?**

Answer:Seed selection and storage are crucial for a successful garden. The author advises choosing non-hybrid seeds, as they can save money and allow gardeners to cultivate their own seeds for future planting. Properly storing seeds by drying them and keeping them in waterproof containers helps maintain their viability, especially for hardy

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varieties that require specific conditions for germination.

### 8.Question

**What lesson does the author impart about persistence and adaptability in gardening?**

Answer:The author imparts a lesson about persistence and adaptability by sharing their experiences with different gardening techniques, climates, and soil conditions. They highlight that challenges, like poor drainage or pest infestations, can be overcome with creativity—such as using rabbit manure for fertilization and understanding one's local environment. They encourage readers to adapt and experiment with methods that work best for their unique situations.

## Chapter 8 | 8. Grain| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What are some cost advantages of buying grain from feed stores compared to grocery stores?**

Answer:Buying grain from feed stores can be significantly cheaper than grocery stores. For

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example, wheat costs about $4.20 per bushel (7¢ per pound) at feed stores, whereas a comparable product like Ralston Wheat Cereal costs 47¢ per pound at the grocery store—representing a price increase of 571%. This shows that buying in bulk from feed stores not only saves money but also provides high-quality grains.

## 2.Question

**How can making your own bread at home with a grinder contribute to financial savings?**

Answer:Investing in a grain grinder, which costs around $19, allows for homemade bread production. The author notes that making their own bread has saved them from purchasing store-bought bread for three years, which yields significant savings as they no longer pay the inflated prices typical in stores.

## 3.Question

**What is the process of sprouting soybeans as portrayed in the text?**

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Answer:To sprout soybeans, soak them in warm water overnight. Then, keep them moist for several days in a dark warm place until the sprouts are about two inches long. They can be rinsed and boiled briefly before serving with soy sauce or cold in salads, illustrating how simple preparation at home can enhance meals.

## 4.Question

**Why does the author suggest that families might benefit from purchasing seed potatoes?**

Answer:Seed potatoes from feed stores are substantially cheaper (costing only $1.50 to $4 for fifty pounds) and while some may be unfit for consumption, the cost efficiency and rich taste make them a great alternative to pricier store-bought potatoes. The author notes that they also create delicious dishes, such as dinner rolls, from these potatoes.

## 5.Question

**What are some culinary uses of wheat mentioned in the chapter?**

Answer:Wheat can be used in various ways, such as making

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breakfast cereal, soup, wheaten cakes, and sandwich bread. The author illustrates versatility by showing that wheat contributes to a healthy diet and provides affordable nourishment. For instance, they enjoy cracking the wheat to create a breakfast cereal or making traditional wheaten cakes.

## 6.Question

**What unique ingredient and technique does the author use in their cooking to enhance flavor?**

Answer:The author mentions adding dill seeds, corn, or soybeans into wheat when grinding for bread to vary the flavor. Additionally, allowing the soybean-wheat dough to rest covered in a warm place for a few days adds a cheesy flavor, showcasing how fermentation can enhance dishes.

## 7.Question

**What lesson about food preparation does the author convey through their experiences shared in this chapter?**

Answer:The author emphasizes the value of DIY food preparation, not only for financial savings but also for health benefits and creativity in cooking. By making their own

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bread, experimenting with grains, and optimizing the usage of inexpensive ingredients, individuals can foster a sustainable lifestyle and enjoy a more varied diet.

## Chapter 9 | 10. Preserving Food| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What are some key methods of preserving food mentioned in this chapter?**

Answer:The key methods of preserving food include drying fruits and herbs, pickling vegetables and herbs, canning meats and fish, and smoke-curing fish. Specific examples provided include drying apples and mushrooms, pickling okra and herbs, canning fish and turtle, and smoking fish to remove moisture and enhance flavor.

### 2.Question

**Why is it important to preserve food, particularly for winter use?**

Answer:Preserving food is vital for ensuring access to dietary staples during winter months when fresh food is harder to

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obtain. It allows for self-sufficiency, reduces the need for constant foraging, and takes advantage of seasonal abundance, ensuring a supply of nutritious food when resources are scarce.

### 3.Question

**What is the process for drying apples as described, and what is a benefit of this method?**

Answer:To dry apples, rinse and core them without peeling, slice them into ¼-inch pieces, steam for five minutes, and place on screens in a dry, warm area until springy. The benefit of this method is that dried apples are convenient snacks that do not require further processing before consumption.

### 4.Question

**How does the method of canning differ from pickling, and what equipment is mentioned for canning?**

Answer:Canning generally involves sealing food in jars and cooking them under pressure to kill bacteria, while pickling involves soaking food in vinegar or brine to preserve it. The

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equipment mentioned for canning includes a pressure cooker, pint jars, and a metal plate to keep jars off the bottom of the cooker.

### 5.Question

**What are the benefits of smoke-curing fish according to the text?**

Answer:Smoke-curing fish prevents spoilage by removing excess moisture, which inhibits microbial growth. Additionally, the process infuses the fish with a distinct smoke flavor and enhances its texture, contributing to its overall preservation.

### 6.Question

**What are some herbs that dry well and how are they prepared for preservation?**

Answer:Herbs like marjoram, thyme, rosemary, oregano, filé, and mint dry well. To prepare them, the cuttings are rinsed and spread on screens in a drying area until brittle. Once dried, they can be stored in sealed jars in a cool, dark place.

### 7.Question

**Explain the significance of enzyme action in the**

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**preservation process mentioned in the chapter.**

Answer:Enzyme action during the preservation process allows for a 'cured' texture and flavor in preserved meats, such as fish. This natural process can enhance taste and quality over time, indicating that preservation is not just about stopping decay but can also improve food characteristics.

## 8.Question

**Why might someone choose to preserve food through pickling as opposed to canning?**

Answer:Someone might choose pickling over canning for its simplicity and the flavor contributions from vinegar and spices. Pickling can be a quicker method that doesn’t require the same level of equipment or process as canning, making it more accessible for preserving certain types of vegetables and herbs.

## 9.Question

**What common kitchen ingredient is recommended for the pickling solution in various recipes?**

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Answer:Vinegar is the common kitchen ingredient recommended for the pickling solution, typically in a 1:2 ratio with water, along with salt and various spices depending on the type of vegetable being preserved.

## 10.Question

**Why is it advised to leave a little mold on dried apples?**

Answer:It is advised that a little mold on dried apples won't hurt, indicating that these small imperfections do not significantly affect the safety or edibility of the food. This reflects a practical approach to food preservation, acknowledging natural occurrences in home preservation.

## 11.Question

**What insights does the author provide about the relationship between food preservation and self-sufficiency?**

Answer:The author emphasizes that food preservation is crucial for self-sufficiency, especially when fresh food is less accessible during certain seasons. By preserving food, one can manage their supplies and rely less on external food

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sources, fostering independence and resilience during times of scarcity.

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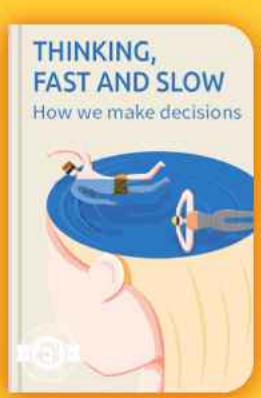
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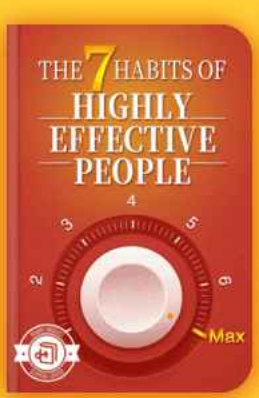
















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## Chapter 10 | 11. Nutrition| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the author's overall perspective on nutrition as discussed in Chapter 10?**

Answer:The author is skeptical of the health industry and its claims, especially the idea of needing to purchase health food to achieve good nutrition. Instead, they advocate for a common-sense approach to diet that relies on natural, whole foods rather than supplements and fad diets.

### 2.Question

**How does the author differentiate between the perceived notion of 'health nuts' and real health?**

Answer:The author points out that many self-proclaimed health enthusiasts are often misled by industry claims and products that don't necessarily improve their health. They give an example of a couple who were strict vegetarians yet could not physically keep up with the author and their father,

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highlighting that true health does not come from adherence to a specific diet, but from balanced, sensible eating habits.

### 3.Question

**What anecdote does the author share to illustrate the fallacy of health claims related to nutrition?**

Answer:The author recalls a visit with vegetarians who believed in the superiority of their diet for health but struggled to perform manual labor, while the author and their father, who did not adhere to a special diet, worked more efficiently. This underscores the point that the claims of 'super health' associated with certain diets are not always substantiated by real-world evidence.

### 4.Question

**What advice does the author give about trusting health claims?**

Answer:The author suggests that one should trust their instincts and common sense when it comes to nutrition. If you're healthy, your body will signal its needs, and the key takeaway is to eat a variety of whole foods while avoiding

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overly processed items.

## 5.Question

**How does the author view the consumption of supplements like vitamin E and cod liver oil?**

Answer:The author argues that there is often misinformation regarding the effectiveness of supplements and warns that combining certain supplements, like cod liver oil and vitamin E, can be counterproductive. They highlight that a proper diet can provide all needed nutrients without the use of supplements.

## 6.Question

**What is the significance of 'possum living' in the context of nutrition?**

Answer:'Possum living' represents a lifestyle that allows individuals the time and energy to prepare and enjoy wholesome meals, rather than relying on quick, unhealthy conveniences. This lifestyle promotes the idea that with a focus on natural food sources, one can achieve sufficient nutrition without stress or financial burden.

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## Chapter 11 | 12. The “Necessities of Life”| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What insights does Dolly Freed provide about the misconceptions surrounding home distillation and alcohol production?**

Answer:Freed emphasizes that many people harbor myths about home-distilled alcohol, often due to misinformation or lack of understanding. She explains that there’s a clear distinction between ethyl alcohol (which is drinkable) and methyl alcohol (which is poisonous), and that proper distillation methods can ensure safety and quality. Additionally, she mentions that commercial spirits can also contain impurities and that the success of home alcohol production often relies on careful practices, not merely the cost or method used.

### 2.Question

**How does the relationship between yeast and humans highlight the interconnectedness in nature?**

Answer:Freed describes yeast as 'little friends' that serve a

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vital role in fermentation, illustrating a symbiotic relationship between humans and yeast. She notes that there would be fewer yeast without humans to cultivate them and conversely, fewer humans would exist without the fermentation process that yeast enables, showcasing a deep connection in the cycle of life.

### 3.Question

**What considerations should be taken into account when choosing ingredients for home brewing?**

Answer:When selecting ingredients, Freed advises using sugars or starchy substances that facilitate fermentation, noting that while fruits can be used, they need to be ripe and might require additional sugar to achieve the desired alcohol content. She highlights that white sugar is reliable and inexpensive, making it an ideal choice for brewing.

### 4.Question

**What practical tips does Freed offer for ensuring a successful fermentation process?**

Answer:Freed suggests using commercially available baker's

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or wine yeasts for consistent results, maintaining a temperature range of 65°F to 90°F for optimal yeast activity, and ensuring clean equipment to avoid contamination. She also mentions the importance of allowing municipal water to sit or be boiled before use to avoid chlorine, which can inhibit yeast.

### 5.Question

**How does Freed challenge the notion that cost equates to value in alcohol production?**

Answer:Freed argues that commercial liquor's high prices are primarily due to taxes and not the quality of the product. She asserts that a quart of quality home-distilled liquor costs significantly less to produce than its commercial counterparts, suggesting that value is more about the process and ingredients than the price tag.

## Chapter 12 | 13. Housing| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the single most important factor for achieving possum living as described in the passage?**

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Answer:Owning your own home free and clear is identified as the key to achieving possum living, providing security and freedom from the constraints of the money economy.

## 2.Question

**How does the author suggest parents should support their children regarding housing and education?**

Answer:The author suggests that rather than spending money on a college education, parents would be better off helping their children buy a house, as it provides security and allows for a more independent future.

## 3.Question

**Why does the author critique the idea of housing as an investment?**

Answer:The author believes that for most ordinary homeowners, paying off a mortgage does not constitute a real investment; it's more about providing security rather than generating wealth.

## 4.Question

**What are some creative housing options mentioned in the**

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**passage that could provide cheaper alternatives?**

Answer:The passage mentions living in converted grain elevators, outmoded schoolhouses, or even barns as viable housing options that can be acquired at low costs.

## 5.Question

**What is described as the primary emotional benefit of owning a home that you have worked on yourself?**

Answer:Living in a home that has become a personal project through one's own labor is described as pleasant and satisfying, offering a sense of accomplishment.

## 6.Question

**What potential challenges are there in seeking out cheap housing as noted in the passage?**

Answer:Finding inexpensive housing is challenged by zoning regulations, the need for cash instead of assets, and the difficulty of competing with speculators at foreclosure sales.

## 7.Question

**What does the author mean by 'miserism' in the context of achieving homeownership?**

Answer:Miserism refers to the practice of scrimping and

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saving over a few years to accumulate enough cash to purchase a home outright, emphasizing financial discipline to secure long-term freedom.

### 8.Question

**How may zoning laws impact one’s ability to find affordable housing?**

Answer:Zoning laws can limit the types of properties available for habitation, making it difficult to convert alternative structures like barns or churches into homes legally.

### 9.Question

**What advice does the author give regarding participating in foreclosure sales?**

Answer:The author advises interested buyers to thoroughly research properties, understand the legal process, and be cautious not to bid more than they can afford to avoid losing their down payment.

### 10.Question

**How does the author suggest people can increase their chances of acquiring distressed properties?**

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Answer:Potential buyers are encouraged to establish relationships with speculators or sellers, explaining their intentions to live in the property rather than flipping it, which may lead to better opportunities.

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## Chapter 13 | 14. Heating| Q&A

### 1.Question

**How can individuals effectively manage their heating costs in an energy-efficient way?**

Answer:Individuals can manage their heating costs by implementing a homemade heating system, such as a wood burner made from repurposed materials, which can drastically reduce reliance on oil. By collecting wood from local sources and minimizing energy use during the night or when away, they can save significantly on fuel bills.

### 2.Question

**What can be learned from the author's approach to heating their home?**

Answer:The author's approach teaches the importance of creativity and resourcefulness. By using simple, cost-effective solutions, like creating an improvised wood stove and planning for solar heating, one can reduce costs and lessen environmental impact.

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## 3.Question

**Why is it important for the author to restore moisture to the air when heating their home?**

Answer:Restoring moisture to the air is crucial because many heating systems dry out indoor air significantly. The author addresses this by placing a cookie sheet of water on the wood stove, thus enhancing comfort and improving air quality.

## 4.Question

**How does the author highlight the connection between indoor temperature and heating efficiency?**

Answer:The author emphasizes that keeping the heating system off during the night minimizes BTU loss, arguing that the exponential cooling of the house actually results in less overall heating energy needed compared to maintaining warmth throughout the night.

## 5.Question

**What modifications did the author make to their living space to improve heating efficiency?**

Answer:The author insulated and sealed off unused windows and converted their sleeping arrangements to the living room

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floor, which helped to retain heat better and required less fuel for heating.

### 6.Question

**How does the author suggest one should utilize natural resources for heating?**

Answer:The author encourages utilizing available natural resources such as dead branches, wooden crates, and newspapers for fuel, suggesting that these are often easily accessible and can substantially reduce heating costs.

### 7.Question

**What future heating strategy does the author plan to implement?**

Answer:The author intends to build a solar heating system using a south-facing wall, black paint, copper pipes, and glass, showing a commitment to sustainable energy practices.

### 8.Question

**What emotional or personal value does the author derive from their unconventional heating methods?**

Answer:The author expresses pride in their ingenuity and the money saved from creating their own heating solutions,

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reflecting a deeper satisfaction with self-sufficiency and connection to their environment.

### 9.Question

**What does the author imply about consumer advice regarding home heating?**

Answer:The author suggests skepticism towards consumer advice, particularly regarding heating practices, arguing that traditional beliefs about constant heating efficiency may be misleading and could lead to unnecessary expenditures.

## Chapter 14 | 15. Electricity| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What can we learn about the role of electricity in our lives from Dolly Freed's perspective?**

Answer:Freed emphasizes that electricity, while convenient and a bargain, is not essential for living a fulfilling life. She points out that many people, including the Amish, thrive without it, suggesting that we can reassess our dependency on modern conveniences and embrace a simpler, less

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electricity-dependent lifestyle.

## 2.Question

**How does Freed's family manage their electricity use to reduce costs?**

Answer:They actively monitor their electricity consumption by using only essential appliances, such as a water pump, and turning off the refrigerator when not needed. They also insulate their fridge and have adapted their food storage practices to avoid reliance on it, showcasing practical strategies for minimal electricity use.

## 3.Question

**What ethical perspective does Freed provide concerning electricity consumption and nuclear power?**

Answer:Freed critiques those who oppose nuclear energy yet continue to use many electricity-dependent appliances, pointing out a hypocrisy in wanting convenience while simultaneously being against the means of generating that convenience. This highlights the importance of being mindful about our energy choices and their broader

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implications.

### 4.Question

**What might contribute to Freed’s decision to wait before investing in wind-powered energy?**

Answer:Freed mentions that technology is constantly improving and prices are decreasing, indicating her preference for making informed, economically sustainable decisions about renewable energy rather than rushing into a purchase that may soon become outdated or overpriced.

### 5.Question

**How does Freed’s approach reflect on the concept of consumerism?**

Answer:Freed challenges consumerism by questioning the necessity of modern electrical appliances and encourages readers to find satisfaction and efficiency in a simpler lifestyle, thus advocating for a mindset that values practicality over consumption.

### 6.Question

**What is the main takeaway regarding happiness and modern technology from this chapter?**

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Answer:The main takeaway is that happiness does not inherently depend on modern technology or electricity. Many lived fulfilling lives prior to widespread electrical use, and discovering joy and satisfaction in simpler living can be just as, if not more, rewarding.

## Chapter 15 | 16. Clothing| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What does the author mean by 'the implementation of buying prestige and status is often through the medium of clothing'?**

Answer:The author suggests that many people, especially women, purchase expensive or fashionable clothing not out of necessity but to showcase their social status and impress others. This behavior highlights a cultural pressure to conform to standards of appearance and affluence.

### 2.Question

**How does the author contrast her family's approach to clothing with that of those who buy new and expensive items?**

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Answer:The author points out that her family acquires their clothing from thrift shops, spending very little while still managing to look presentable. They prioritize practicality and frugality over appearance, contrasting with those who overspend to signal wealth.

### 3.Question

**What does the author imply about the relationship between clothing and self-worth or identity?**

Answer:The author implies that true self-worth should not be tied to the expensive clothing one wears. Despite her thrift shop wardrobe, she feels confident and attractive, suggesting that personal value comes from within rather than external appearances.

### 4.Question

**What broader critique about consumer culture does the author offer through her observations about women's shopping habits?**

Answer:The author critiques consumer culture's focus on materialism, particularly how women may feel compelled to buy clothing to validate their status among peers, ultimately

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leading to waste (as evidenced by discarded clothing in thrift shops). This critique invites readers to reflect on their own values and spending habits.

### 5.Question

**Why does the author find it puzzling that women would lie to their husbands about the costs of their clothing?**

Answer:The author finds it puzzling because it illustrates a disconnect between financial honesty within relationships and societal pressures to maintain a certain image. This behavior raises questions about integrity and the lengths to which individuals go to uphold a facade.

### 6.Question

**How does the experience of shopping at thrift stores shape the author's perspective on clothing and self-image?**

Answer:Shopping at thrift stores fosters a sense of creativity and resourcefulness in the author. By valuing affordability and uniqueness over brand names, she develops a healthier self-image that prioritizes personal style over societal expectations.

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## 7.Question

**What can we learn from the author's perspective on fashion and consumerism?**

Answer:We can learn that valuing authenticity and practicality over material possessions leads to a more sustainable and genuinely fulfilling lifestyle. It's possible to maintain individuality and confidence without succumbing to consumer pressures.

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## Chapter 16 | 17. Transportation| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What does the author suggest about the relationship between cars and culture?**

Answer:The author compares automobiles to the role of horses in the culture of the Plains Indians, indicating that cars are a central aspect of suburban culture, representing status and lifestyle. This analogy highlights the deep integration of cars in modern society, and how they shape social interactions and perceptions.

### 2.Question

**How does the author view the conveniences and inconveniences of car ownership?**

Answer:The author acknowledges that while there are conveniences associated with car ownership, such as mobility, these are outweighed by numerous inconveniences like costs (insurance, maintenance), environmental concerns, and social pressures. This perspective encourages readers to

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reconsider the necessity and true cost of owning a car.

### 3.Question

**What alternative modes of transportation does the author advocate for?**

Answer:Suggesting walking, running, and biking as practical transportation options, the author emphasizes the benefits of being more aware of the surroundings and enjoying the journey rather than rushing through it in a car. This promotes a lifestyle that values simplicity, health, and engagement with the community.

### 4.Question

**What is the significance of using a bicycle for transportation according to the author?**

Answer:The author highlights the practicality of using a three-speed bike over a ten-speed, citing ease of use, maintenance, and less theft risk. By emphasizing bicycle usage, the author points to a sustainable and cost-effective mode of transport that aligns with their values of frugality and environmental consciousness.

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## 5.Question

**What solution does the author propose for overcoming challenges related to carrying large items?**

Answer:The author suggests leveraging community connections by exchanging favors with friends who have greater means or access. This reflects a resourceful and cooperative approach to problem-solving in a self-sufficient lifestyle.

## 6.Question

**How did the author find a way to access a horse without owning one?**

Answer:The author was able to use a horse that belonged to a neighbor who did not have the time for exercise. This arrangement illustrates how community sharing and collaboration can provide resources without the financial burden of ownership.

## 7.Question

**What entrepreneurial idea does the author consider regarding horse boarding?**

Answer:The author contemplates building a stable and

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boarding horses, suggesting that this could generate income while providing transportation and resources like manure for gardening. This idea reflects creativity and a proactive approach to capitalizing on available opportunities.

## Chapter 17 | 18. Law| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What does the author suggest about the relationship between honesty and law?**

Answer:The author, Dolly Freed, suggests that if you are honest and fair, you may not need a lawyer at all. She believes that a society requiring honest individuals to hire professionals to communicate on their behalf is flawed. Instead, you should know your rights and handle disputes yourself.

### 2.Question

**What method did Dolly Freed's father use to retrieve money from a dishonest realtor?**

Answer:Dolly Freed's father visited the realtor's house late at night to confront him after he had been defrauded. By

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catching the realtor's attention in a serious manner, he prompted the realtor to return the money, plus interest, demonstrating the power of direct personal engagement.

### 3.Question

**What is the author's attitude towards the legal system as a whole?**

Answer:The author acknowledges that while the legal system can be useful, it often fails to deliver true justice. She criticizes the greed she perceives in lawyers and certain individuals within the system and offers her father's unconventional methods as alternatives.

### 4.Question

**According to the author, what is the ultimate goal when dealing with disputes?**

Answer:The ultimate goal when handling disputes is to seek justice rather than revenge or personal satisfaction. The author emphasizes that the focus should be on resolving the issue and reaching a fair outcome.

### 5.Question

**What warning does the author give about losing one’s**

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**temper during disputes?**

Answer:The author warns that losing your temper can lead to disastrous outcomes, citing a friend who threatened a lawyer in court and ended up incarcerated. Maintaining calmness is essential for achieving a favorable resolution.

## 6.Question

**How does the author view the role of personal ethics in conflict resolution?**

Answer:The author believes that personal ethics play a crucial role in conflict resolution. She contends that individuals must determine whether their actions contribute to justice, suggesting that the ends may justify the means in certain situations as long as one is confident of their righteousness.

## 7.Question

**What steps does the author outline for confronting an adversary?**

Answer:The author outlines a series of steps, including calmly explaining your position, later intimidating them

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through subtle threats, and visiting their home to assert pressure without being overtly aggressive. The focus is on psychological leverage rather than direct confrontational tactics.

## 8.Question

**What does the author imply about the nature of law versus justice?**

Answer:The author implies that law often serves as a poor substitute for true justice. She articulates that legal frameworks may not always align with morality or fairness, and that people often exploit legal loopholes to act unethically.

## 9.Question

**How does the author suggest one should deal with the stress of legal issues?**

Answer:The author suggests that instead of allowing legal disputes to linger in one's mind, it is better to actively seek resolution in a timely manner. Waiting can be harmful to one's mental health, especially for individuals who are

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sensitive to stress.

## Chapter 18 | 19. Health and Medicine| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the author's overall attitude towards modern healthcare compared to the past?**

Answer:The author expresses gratitude for modern medical advancements that prevent horrendous diseases prevalent in earlier times, yet critiques the high costs associated with healthcare today, suggesting that the expenses can be misleading and questioning the need for excessive medical interventions.

### 2.Question

**How does the author suggest one should deal with health concerns?**

Answer:The author suggests that maintaining a healthy outlook on life is crucial, stating that worrying about illness negates the joy of living. They emphasize the importance of physical activity, particularly running, as a means to stay

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healthy without the burdens of medical expenses or therapies.

### 3.Question

**What is the significance of the example of the man with a congenital heart condition?**

Answer:The man exemplifies courage and a zest for life, choosing to live fully and die on his own terms rather than languishing in discomfort or fear of illness. This serves as a critique of a society overly focused on health insurance and prolonged life through medical means.

### 4.Question

**How does the author's personal experience influence their perspective on therapies and medical care?**

Answer:The author shares experiences that highlight skepticism toward conventional therapies and medical interventions, suggesting that many problems resolve naturally over time and that personal experience should guide health decisions, rather than blind trust in authorities.

### 5.Question

**What lifestyle choices does the author advocate for health and well-being?**

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Answer:The author advocates for a lifestyle that includes running, maintaining a nutritious diet, utilizing home remedies rather than relying on expensive medical treatments, and developing a positive mindset to ensure both physical and mental health.

## 6.Question

**In what ways does the author challenge conventional wisdom regarding health and medicine?**

Answer:The author challenges the notion that expensive therapies and medical interventions are necessary for health, arguing instead for self-reliance, using common sense, and listening to one's own experiences to navigate health issues.

## 7.Question

**What antidote does the author propose for dealing with emotional issues?**

Answer:The author proposes physical activity, specifically running, as a powerful antidote for emotional struggles, claiming that it can provide clarity and improved mental health rather than succumbing to therapies that might not be

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effective.

## 8.Question

**What is the author's view on the relationship between physical health and mental well-being?**

Answer:The author emphasizes a strong connection between physical activity and mental health, suggesting that an active lifestyle leads to a clearer mind and emotional resilience, while lack of activity can lead to negative thoughts and feelings.

## 9.Question

**How does the author encourage readers to navigate health-related fears?**

Answer:The author encourages readers to focus on living life fully and embracing daily challenges rather than succumbing to fears about health, maintaining that a healthy mindset is key to dispelling anxieties related to illness and mortality.

## 10.Question

**What conclusion does the author draw about leading a meaningful life?**

Answer:The author concludes that a natural, healthy life, free

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from societal pressures related to health and success, can lead to a fulfilling existence with inherent purpose, suggesting that true contentment and meaning stem from simple living.

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## Chapter 19 | 20. Daily Living| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What can we learn about boredom from Dolly Freed's perspective in 'Possum Living'?**

Answer:Dolly Freed highlights that boredom can lead to serious consequences, as it has been historically linked to negative actions such as murders and wars. However, she also notes that boredom is an inevitable part of life and encourages finding meaningful activities to engage in, rather than succumbing to the dullness of routine. She emphasizes creativity and resourcefulness in overcoming boredom, advocating for a lifestyle that intertwines work and leisure.

### 2.Question

**How does Dolly Freed view the importance of television in her life?**

Answer:Dolly Freed expresses a strong aversion to television, seeing it as a source of unrest and a distraction

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from reality. She believes that it can distort one's perception of life and thoughts, warning that it can negatively influence her mind. Instead, she prefers to engage in activities that foster genuine interactions and personal growth.

### 3.Question

**What does Dolly Freed suggest about integrating work and leisure in daily life?**

Answer:Dolly suggests that work and leisure should not be rigidly separated, as the enjoyment of nature and gathering food can be both a recreational and productive activity. She illustrates this point with the example of gathering nuts for food while bird watching, demonstrating that one's daily tasks can be fulfilling and pleasurable.

### 4.Question

**How does Dolly Freed's view on education differ from traditional schooling?**

Answer:Freed critiques traditional education, stating that it often fails to teach practical life skills and knowledge that truly matter. She argues for a self-directed approach to

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learning, where individuals pursue knowledge outside of the school system, focusing on skills that are useful and relevant to their lives.

## 5.Question

**What does Dolly Freed mean by 'freedom to have freedom of choice,' and how does this relate to her lifestyle?**

Answer:Freed asserts that embracing a lifestyle like hers grants individuals the confidence to make personal choices about their lives without being tethered to conventional work or societal expectations. This freedom extends to the ability to travel, explore new activities, and create a life that aligns with personal values and desires.

## 6.Question

**Why does Dolly Freed consider her lifestyle a form of empowerment?**

Answer:Freed believes her lifestyle empowers her to live authentically and independently, free from the pressures of societal norms. She cherishes the ability to explore life's possibilities without the constraints of a conventional job,

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thereby fostering creativity, resilience, and self-sufficiency.

## 7.Question

**What is Dolly Freed's outlook on future adventures, like the potential boat trip to Florida?**

Answer:Freed expresses excitement about the possibility of embarking on new adventures, such as a year-long journey by boat to Florida. This represents her desire for exploration and living off the land, reinforcing the idea that a possum lifestyle promotes freedom, adventure, and the pursuit of dreams.

## 8.Question

**How does Dolly Freed's narrative in 'Possum Living' challenge societal expectations?**

Answer:Freed's narrative challenges societal expectations by rejecting the traditional 9-to-5 work model and promoting a lifestyle centered around self-sufficiency, creativity, and enjoyment. She advocates for breaking free from conformity and embracing a unique way of living that aligns with personal values and passions.

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### 9.Question

**How does Dolly Freed encourage others to transform their hobbies into occupations?**

Answer:Freed encourages readers to rethink their hobbies and consider how to incorporate them into their daily lives in a meaningful way. She posits that activities like gardening, fishing, or art can provide fulfillment beyond mere recreation and that it's feasible to turn these passions into valuable pursuits.

### 10.Question

**What overall message does Dolly Freed convey about living life authentically?**

Answer:The overall message conveyed by Freed is that authentic living comes from embracing personal values, pursuing passions, and finding joy in the simplicity of life. She urges others to seek out their desires fearlessly and confidently, creating a lifestyle that reflects their true selves.

## Chapter 20 | Nine More Years of Tried and True Lessons| Q&A

### 1.Question

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**What does it mean to be a 'half possuming' individual?**

Answer:Being a 'half possuming' individual signifies a balance between frugality and regular comforts of modern life. It describes someone who embraces minimalism by cooking their own meals and gardening while still maintaining a car and keeping pets, showing that one can live simply while also enjoying certain conveniences.

## 2.Question

**How can aging affect one's approach to gardening and what solutions can be found?**

Answer:Aging can limit physical abilities, making activities like gardening challenging. The author faced limitations due to arthritis but adapted by finding gardening partners. This solution allowed her to continue cultivating a garden without overexerting herself, emphasizing community engagement and collaboration as a meaningful approach.

## 3.Question

**What is the importance of having an emergency fund**

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**according to the author?**

Answer:An emergency fund is crucial as it provides financial security and control over unexpected life situations. The author stresses that a well-maintained emergency fund can mean the difference between life and death in serious situations, as evidenced by real-life stories of individuals who suffered due to lack of funds.

## 4.Question

**What lessons did the author learn from her children's experiences with education and financial independence?**

Answer:The author's children learned to balance education costs with financial responsibility, leading them to avoid crippling debt. They pursued scholarships and worked while studying, contributing to their independence and personal growth—especially David, who found a path in life without the burden of debt.

## 5.Question

**How does the author describe the relationship between cooking and quality of life?**

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Answer:Cooking is portrayed as a vital practice that enhances health, saves money, and nurtures relationships. The author emphasizes that dedicating time to cook better meals enriches one’s life and improves overall well-being, creating meaningful social interactions.

## 6.Question

**What challenges did Maria face with the used van, and what was the outcome?**

Answer:Maria faced an unexpected mishap when the valet crashed their used van, but she adeptly handled the situation by remaining composed, which led to the hotel manager covering the damages. This experience underlines the benefits of owning a used vehicle, highlighting the practical lessons of reducing costs while still embracing adventures.

## 7.Question

**Why is 'possume time' essential, according to the author?**

Answer:'Possum time' is essential as it allows individuals to step back from the hustle of daily life and engage in meaningful activities—be it cooking, spending time with

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loved ones, or simply relaxing. It encourages a balance that fosters creativity, relaxation, and personal fulfillment, critical for a fulfilling life.

## 8.Question

**What advice does the author give about shared living arrangements?**

Answer:The author advises clear communication about living arrangements with family or housemates to prevent conflicts. Discussions should cover personal boundaries, shared responsibilities, and potential issues, encouraging an open dialogue to maintain harmony in close living quarters.

## 9.Question

**In what ways does the author demonstrate the concept of working with what you have?**

Answer:The author illustrates this concept by adapting her gardening practices as her physical abilities changed, transforming her garden into a community project and enriching her neighborhood. This adaptability highlights the possum living philosophy of making the best out of one’s

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circumstances.

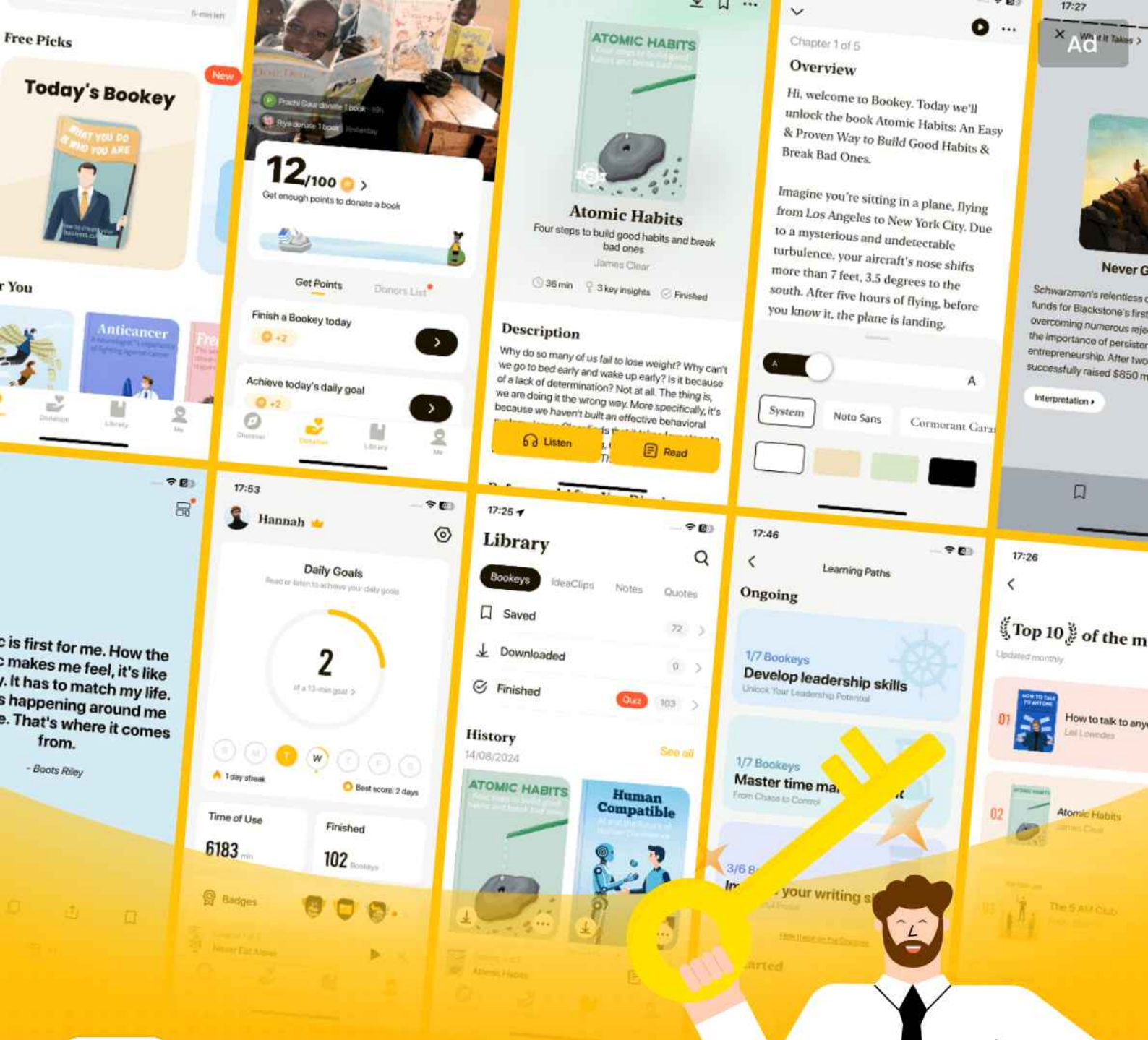
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# Possum Living Quiz and Test

Check the Correct Answer on Bookey Website

## Chapter 1 | An Introduction to Possum Living| Quiz and Test

1. Dolly Freed believes that individuals cannot escape the 9-to-5 lifestyle without living in isolation or joining a commune.
2. The author critiques the societal fixation on economic growth and metrics like GNP, stating that humanity has thrived without them for centuries.
3. This book solely provides practical money-saving advice without encouraging independent thinking about economics.

## Chapter 2 | 1. We Quit the Rat Race| Quiz and Test

1. Diogenes believed that possessions complicate life and advocated for minimalism.
2. The author's family achieved financial stability without any entrepreneurship.
3. After a divorce, the author viewed their lifestyle as a true

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luxury.

## Chapter 3 | 2. The Cost of Living| Quiz and Test

1. The estimated cost for a family of four to maintain a normal standard of living in 1976 was reported as $5,500 annually.
2. The author's family spends approximately $1,498.75 annually, which is higher than the average reported cost.
3. Excluding home improvement materials, the total essential living expenses for the author's family is $1,163.33.

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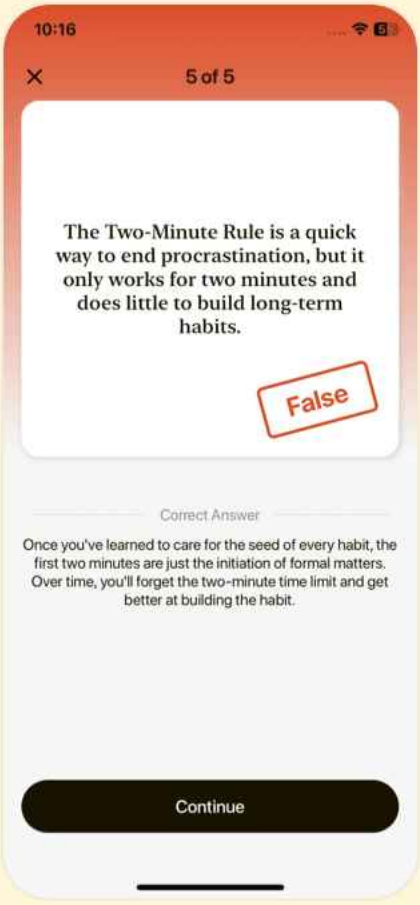
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## Chapter 4 | 3. Income| Quiz and Test

1. The author suggests that crafting and selling surplus plants can yield significant income.
2. The author believes that avoiding sales tax is a recommended practice when selling crafts without registration.
3. Starting a craft business is stated to be inexpensive, and pricing should reflect the quality and cost of making the items.

## Chapter 5 | 4. We Rassle with Our Consciences| Quiz and Test

1. Dolly Freed's lifestyle choice is ideologically driven rather than practical.
2. Dolly and her partner reject societal norms and embrace laziness as a valid lifestyle.
3. Dolly believes that worrying about future job security is a sign of being responsible.

## Chapter 6 | 6. Fish| Quiz and Test

1. Fish is a primary food source in various regions, as

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described in the book.

2.The author believes that only popular fish varieties provide a good source of protein.

3.Cleaning fish is a complicated task that requires advanced skills according to the author.

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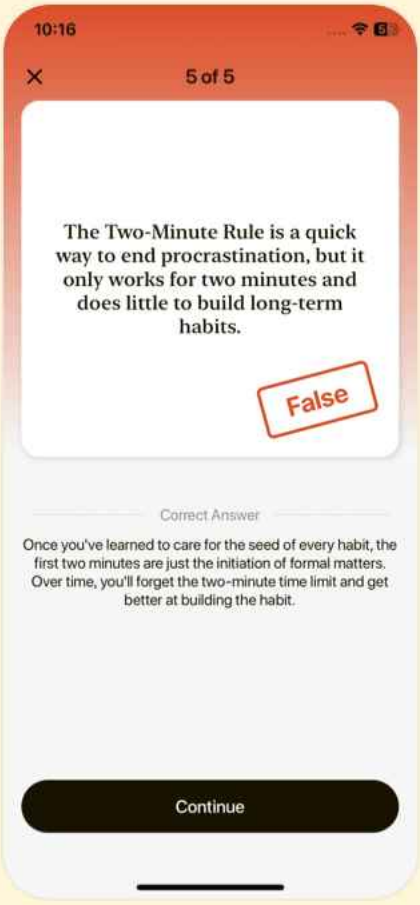
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## Chapter 7 | 7. Gardening| Quiz and Test

1. Gardening requires advanced skills to be successful.
2. Composting can be improved by utilizing animal waste such as rabbit and chicken manure.
3. Foraging should be done without any caution as all wild plants are safe to eat.

## Chapter 8 | 8. Grain| Quiz and Test

1. You can buy human food at feed-and-grain stores, including potatoes and soybeans.
2. Grocery store prices for wheat are around 5-10% higher than feed store prices.
3. Soy snackies are made by soaking and frying soybeans until they are dark brown.

## Chapter 9 | 10. Preserving Food| Quiz and Test

1. In winter, food does not require preservation according to 'Possum Living'.
2. Jars for storing dried herbs should be sealed according to the preservation methods in 'Possum Living'.

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3.Canning is the most preferred method of food preservation in 'Possum Living'.

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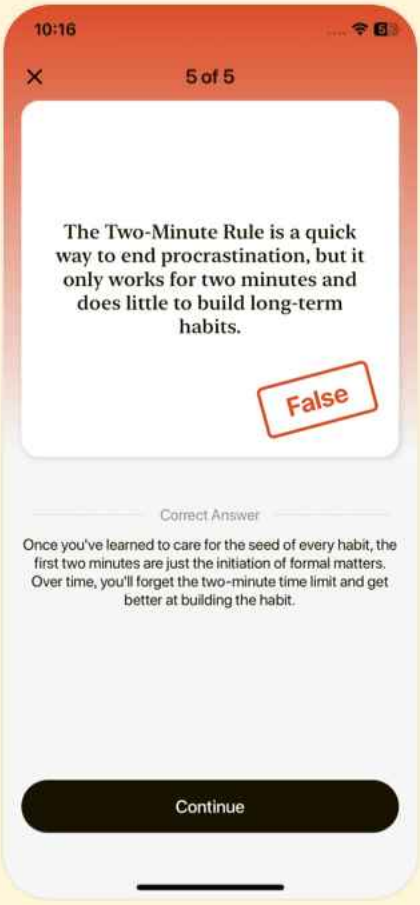
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## Chapter 10 | 11. Nutrition| Quiz and Test

1. The author believes that individuals practicing 'possum living' should rely on buying health products for their nutrition.
2. The author critiques the marketing of supplements, stating that many athletes have found performance improvements from them.
3. According to the author, populations like the Eskimos thrive without consuming green vegetables, contradicting common nutritional advice.

## Chapter 11 | 12. The “Necessities of Life”| Quiz and Test

1. Homemade alcohol can be considered safer to drink than commercial alcohol if understood properly.
2. High prices for alcohol always guarantee higher quality, especially in homemade varieties.
3. Baker's yeast and wine yeast are identical in effectiveness for alcohol production.

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## Chapter 12 | 13. Housing| Quiz and Test

1. Housing is crucial for achieving financial independence, as it provides security and freedom.
2. Renting a home is a better option than owning outright for achieving a leisurely approach to life.
3. Property taxes should not be assessed based on the current conditions of a property before major renovations.

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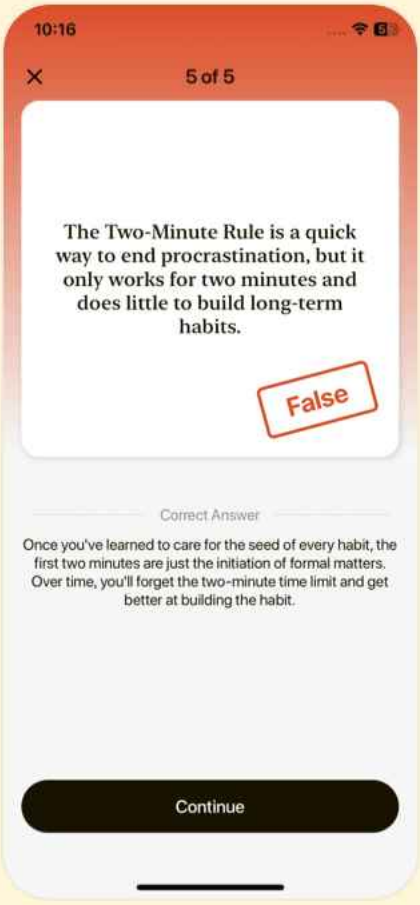
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## Chapter 13 | 14. Heating| Quiz and Test

1. The author plans to replace the oil burner with a wood burner to reduce oil consumption.
2. The homemade wood burner was constructed using expensive materials and costs around $100 to build.
3. The author asserts that turning off the heat at night increases energy expenditures.

## Chapter 14 | 15. Electricity| Quiz and Test

1. Electricity is considered essential for life according to the book 'Possum Living'.
2. The author of 'Possum Living' uses about 230 kilowatt-hours of electricity bi-monthly for essential appliances.
3. The author encourages excessive use of electric appliances as a way to oppose nuclear power.

## Chapter 15 | 16. Clothing| Quiz and Test

1. Clothing is often used as a means to convey status and prestige, especially among women.
2. The author and her family purchase all of their clothing

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brand new to avoid the negative stereotypes associated with thrifted clothing.

3. Buying clothes is often more economical than making them, particularly for rapidly growing children.

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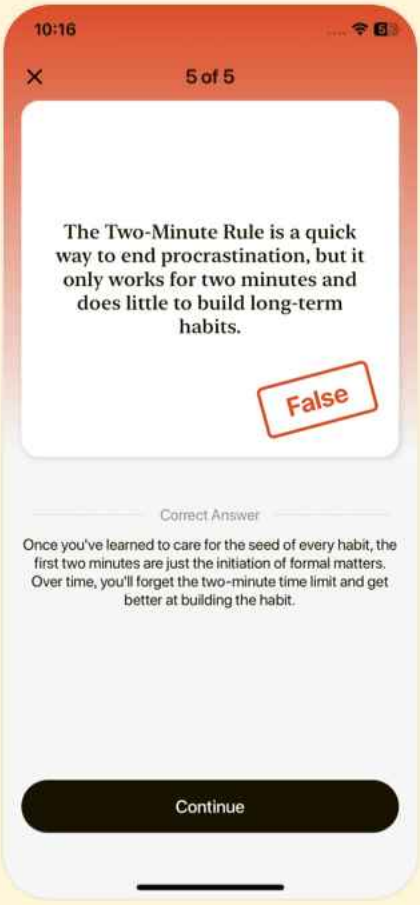
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## Chapter 16 | 17. Transportation| Quiz and Test

1. Cars are a symbol of status and convenience in modern society.
2. The author prefers ten-speed bikes for their practicality and cost-effectiveness.
3. The author uses a horse for most of their transportation needs.

## Chapter 17 | 18. Law| Quiz and Test

1. Dolly Freed believes that individuals should be completely reliant on lawyers for navigating legal disputes.
2. Freed emphasizes the importance of knowing one's constitutional rights.
3. According to Freed, the legal system is designed to efficiently provide justice to individuals.

## Chapter 18 | 19. Health and Medicine| Quiz and Test

1. Dolly Freed appreciates the advances in medical science and its ability to eliminate many diseases.
2. Freed advocates for spending heavily on healthcare and

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annual checkups as essential for maintaining health.

3. Freed believes that a connection exists between physical health, psychology, and philosophy, advocating for a holistic view of health.

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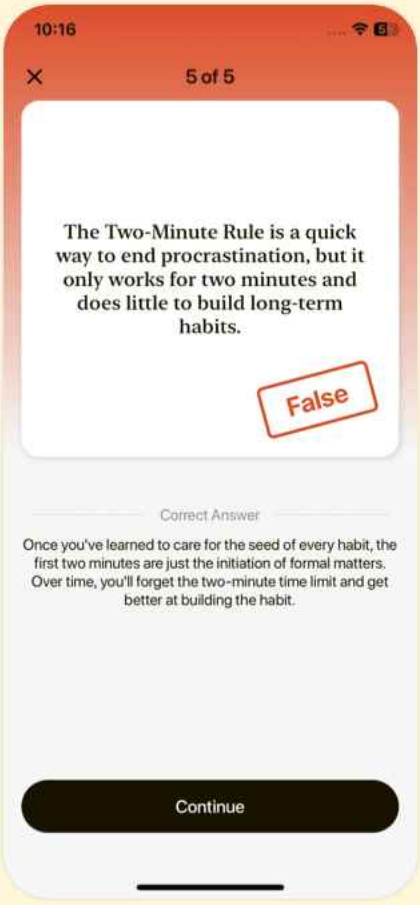
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## Chapter 19 | 20. Daily Living| Quiz and Test

1. Dolly Freed's family owns a TV and enjoys watching it during their leisure time.
2. During winter, the family reduces their daily tasks to two hours and engages in activities like reading and music to combat boredom.
3. In spring, the family does not merge work with enjoyment and focuses solely on gardening without enjoyment.

## Chapter 20 | Nine More Years of Tried and True Lessons| Quiz and Test

1. Possum living allows for a flexible engagement level based on personal circumstances.
2. The author believes that having an emergency fund is unimportant for financial stability.
3. The author advocates for cooking at home, stating it is essential for health and finances.

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